UNIVERSITY COLLEGE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES



FACULTY OF EDUCATION

DEPARTMENT OF BASIC EDUCATION

TEACHING PRACTICE PORTFOLIO

BY

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(2221168)

A PORTFOLIO SUBMITTED TO THE FACULTY OF EDUCATION, UNIVERSITY COLLEGE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES, IN PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE REQUIREMENTS FOR THE AWARD OF THE BACHELOR OF EDUCATION IN BASIC EDUCATION

ACADEMIC YEAR: 2025/2026

SUBMISSION DATE: .....

UNIVERSITY COLLEGE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES (UCOMS)

(Affiliated to the University of Education, Winneba)

FACULTY OF EDUCATION

DEPARTMENT OF BASIC EDUCATION

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Submitted to the Faculty of Education, University College of Management Studies (UCOMS), in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the Bachelor of Education in Basic Education.

NAME: Samuel Kwabena Boateng

INDEX NUMBER: 2221168

PROGRAMME: Bachelor of Education in Basic Education (Upper Primary)

TEACHING PRACTICE SCHOOL: St. Martin De Porres School

LOCATION: Dansoman, Accra

CLASS TAUGHT: Year 6 (21 pupils)

SUBJECTS TAUGHT: English Language and Computing

ACADEMIC YEAR: 2025/2026

SUPERVISOR: Aaron Seyram Kwasi Grace-Oak

SUBMISSION DATE: .....

SIGNATURE: .....

APPROVAL SHEET

This is to certify that this Teaching Practice Portfolio has been examined and approved as meeting the requirements for the award of the Bachelor of Education in Basic Education at the University College of Management Studies (UCOMS), Accra, affiliated to the University of Education, Winneba.

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DECLARATION

I, Samuel Kwabena Boateng, hereby declare that this Teaching Practice Portfolio is my own original work carried out during my four-week teaching practice at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman, in the Ablekuma West Municipality of the Greater Accra Region, in June 2026.

This portfolio has not been submitted either in part or in whole for the award of any academic qualification in this or any other institution of higher learning. All sources of information, citations, literature and instructional frameworks used in this portfolio have been duly acknowledged.

Student's Name: Samuel Kwabena Boateng

Index Number: 2221168

Signature: ..... Date: .....

Supervisor's Name: Aaron Seyram Kwasi Grace-Oak

Signature: ..... Date: .....

DEDICATION

This portfolio is dedicated to God Almighty, whose grace, wisdom, and strength sustained me throughout my academic programme and the demanding weeks of the teaching practicum.

I also dedicate this work to my family for their unwavering encouragement, sacrifice, prayers, and steadfast belief in my calling as an educator.

Finally, this work is dedicated to my Year 6 learners at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman, whose bright minds, eager questions, and enthusiasm for coding and grammar made every lesson a deeply rewarding experience.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I wish to express my profound gratitude to the Almighty God for His abundant mercy, good health, and guidance throughout my teaching practice journey.

My sincere appreciation goes to the Faculty of Education at the University College of Management Studies (UCOMS) for their academic preparation, support, and dedication to excellence in teacher education.

I am deeply indebted to my practicum supervisor, Aaron Seyram Kwasi Grace-Oak, whose rigorous academic guidance, insightful classroom observations, constructive feedback, and high standards shaped my instructional delivery and the development of this portfolio.

I extend my heartfelt gratitude to the management, staff, and learners of St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman. In particular, I thank the Headteacher, Mr Victor Kablan, for welcoming me into the school community, and my mentor teacher, Miss Angela Ankomah, for her exemplary mentorship, guidance in navigating the Oxford International Curriculum alongside the NaCCA syllabus, and generous sharing of classroom wisdom.

I also thank the Year 6 learners and the robotics team who represented the school at CODEAVOUR 7.0 for their teamwork and enthusiasm, which brought pride to the school.

Lastly, to my family, colleagues, and friends, thank you for your constant support, prayers, and words of encouragement.

ABSTRACT

This teaching practice portfolio documents the official Level 400 teaching practicum completed by Samuel Kwabena Boateng at St. Martin De Porres School in Dansoman, Accra, from 1 to 25 June 2026. The placement was undertaken in Year 6 (21 learners) under the Oxford International Curriculum (OIC) and the National Council for Curriculum and Assessment (NaCCA) / Ghana Education Service (GES) frameworks, focusing on English Language and Computing. At the core of the portfolio is a classroom action-research project addressing a diagnosed learning gap in grammar instruction: learners demonstrated high proficiency in identifying passive voice (93.3%), but their ability to transform active sentences into passive voice was lower (44.8%). A four-lesson scaffolded intervention used a four-step transformation routine, tense-preservation rules and visual scaffolding charts. After the intervention, the class mean on the target conversion skill rose from 2.24/5 (44.8%) to 4.57/5 (91.4%), a descriptive increase of 2.33 marks or 46.6 percentage points; 19 of 21 pupils improved. These descriptive results do not, by themselves, establish causation, and no inferential statistic is reported because the individual paired scores were not available for independent verification. In Computing, pupils were guided through block-based programming in Scratch, culminating in a practical assessment with a class mean of 76.5%. After the official practicum, the student teacher remained at the school informally until the end of the academic term, taught mainly Computing, and joined the school's robotics team for CODEAVOUR 7.0, where the team placed first. The portfolio concludes with reflective commentary, a curriculum vitae and practical recommendations for continued professional growth.

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CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION AND PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY

1.1 Statement of purpose

This portfolio presents a structured account of my work as a student teacher at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman, where I taught English Language and Computing in Year 6. It is at once a record of practice and a mirror of growth. It gathers the plans I prepared, the lessons I taught, the assessments I designed, and the reflections I made along the way. Through it I demonstrate developing competence in planning for instruction, managing a classroom, differentiating for diverse learners, integrating technology, and using assessment to improve teaching and learning.

St. Martin De Porres School offers the Oxford International Curriculum (OIC) alongside the national curriculum framework of the National Council for Curriculum and Assessment (NaCCA) and the Ghana Education Service (GES). Working within this dual framework required lessons that were internationally benchmarked and still rooted in the Ghanaian context. The evidence assembled here reflects that commitment: a full grammar unit built around an identified classroom problem, four consecutive lesson plans from that unit, teaching and learning materials, pre- and post-test instruments with class results, photographic evidence of practice (Figures 2.1–2.7), and a parallel Computing unit on programming with Scratch.

Above all, the portfolio expresses a simple professional conviction: teaching is a vocation of service, and the reflective teacher, not the perfect one, is the teacher who keeps improving. Weaknesses are recorded as candidly as strengths.

1.2 Teaching philosophy

I believe that every child is a whole person - intellectual, social, emotional, physical and spiritual - and that the classroom must nurture these dimensions together. My practice is therefore learner-centred. I plan from what learners already know, I engage them through questioning, collaboration and discovery, and I assess not to rank them but to find out what each child needs next.

I also believe that language carries learning. As an English Language teacher in a multilingual Ghanaian classroom, I see myself as a bridge-builder between the languages children bring from home and the academic English they need for school and life. As a Computing teacher, I see technology not as a subject to be memorised but as a tool for thinking, creating and solving real problems. In both subjects the goal is the same: confident, curious learners who can express themselves clearly and think for themselves.

Two further principles guide daily decisions. First, diversity of ability, language and background is a planning fact, not an inconvenience: differentiated instruction is ordinary good teaching. Second, assessment should be diagnostic as well as summative. The action research at the centre of this portfolio exists because a class that could label active and passive sentences could not convert them. That gap was not a verdict on the children. It was information about the teaching.

1.3 Mission and vision

Mission

To provide every learner in my care with purposeful, well-planned and inclusive instruction that builds strong literacy, digital competence and sound character, so that

each child leaves the classroom more confident, more curious and better equipped for the next stage of learning.

Vision

To become an exemplary Ghanaian educator and educational resource developer whose classrooms, materials and mentorship raise the standard of teaching and learning in basic schools across Ghana.

These statements are intentions, not achievements. The practicum cannot realise a career vision. It can, however, show whether the intentions are lived: in the unit designs in Chapter Three, in the adaptations in Chapter Four, and in the honest account of difficulty in Chapters Five and Six.

1.4 Why I want to teach

I chose teaching because it is one of the few professions in which the daily work is the formation of other people's capacity to think, speak and act. English Language matters because it is the medium through which most other school learning travels in Ghana. Computing matters because the world my Year 6 learners will work in is already digital, and because the subject, taught well, is less about devices than about clear thinking.

I also want to teach because I enjoy the craft itself: the drafting of a lesson until only what causes learning remains; the moment a conversion clicks for a child who had been guessing; the discipline of changing the plan when the class tells you, by their work, that the plan is wrong. That craft is what this portfolio tries to show.

CHAPTER TWO

THE TEACHING PRACTICE SITE

2.1 Profile of St. Martin De Porres School

St. Martin De Porres School is a well-established Catholic basic school in Dansoman, in the Ablekuma West Municipality of Accra. Founded in October 1973 and named after St. Martin de Porres, the patron saint of social justice and compassion, the school has a long reputation for academic work, discipline and moral formation. It serves learners from creche and nursery through kindergarten to Junior High School / lower secondary. The learner population is slightly over one thousand, with a teaching staff of about eighty, supported by non-teaching staff. The school is headed by Mr Victor Kablan.

A distinctive feature of the school is its curriculum. In addition to the national curriculum developed by NaCCA under the Ghana Education Service, the school runs the Oxford International Curriculum, which provides internationally benchmarked schemes in English, Mathematics, Science and Computing, with a strong emphasis on wellbeing and global skills. For a student teacher this was a rare chance to plan and teach across two frameworks at once.

The tone of the school, prayerful, disciplined and warm, made it a conducive place for children to learn and for a young teacher to grow. Security personnel and clear routines keep the compound orderly. Classrooms are well lit, with tiled floors, ceiling fans, and individual desks. A computer laboratory served my Computing lessons; the school also maintains a library and facilities for sports and worship.

2.2 Facilities, staff and learner population

Table 2.1 School facilities

Facility	Description
Classrooms	Furnished, ventilated rooms with paired desks and chairs for kindergarten through JHS
Library	Textbooks, reading materials and reference resources supporting the OIC, with librarian support
Computer laboratory	ICT laboratory used for digital literacy and Computing lessons, including Scratch
Playground / sports field	Outdoor space for physical education, recreation and extracurricular activity
Staff room and offices	Planning space for teachers; offices for the headteacher and administrative staff
Sanitation and canteen	Wash facilities for pupils and staff; canteen providing meals at break

Table 2.2 Line of authority (simplified)

Position	Role
School Board	Policy direction and oversight
Executive leadership	Strategic and institutional management
Headteacher - Mr Victor Kablan	Day-to-day administration and academic leadership
Section supervisors	Oversight of kindergarten, lower primary, upper primary and JHS
Teachers / facilitators	Classroom instruction and assessment

Position	Role
Support units	Guidance and counselling, operations, human resource, infirmary, security

Table 2.3 Approximate enrolment by section

Section	Approximate enrolment
Kindergarten (KG 1 & KG 2)	about 120
Lower primary (Years 1–3)	about 270
Upper primary (Years 4–6)	about 400
Junior High School (JHS 1–3)	about 270
Total	about 1,000–1,100

Figures in Tables 2.1–2.3 are approximate working descriptions assembled during the placement. They are offered to locate the practicum, not as an official census of the school.

2.3 The Year 6 class

Table 2.4 Year 6 class profile

Detail	Information
Number of pupils	21
Year level	Year 6 (upper primary)
Age range	11–13 years
Gender	Mixed
Curriculum	Oxford International Curriculum, with NaCCA/GES alignment

Detail	Information
Subjects taught by the student teacher	English Language (grammar focus) and Computing
Mentor	Miss Angela Ankomah

The OIC assessment framework progresses from Knowledge to Understanding to Application and beyond, in the spirit of Bloom's taxonomy, and uses a spiral design so that pupils revisit and deepen ideas year by year. During the practicum it became clear that although the Year 6 English programme expected Application-level work on voice, many pupils did not yet hold the tense knowledge that conversion requires. That observation became the action-research problem reported in Chapter Five.

2.4 Photographs of practice

The photographs in this section (Figures 2.1–2.7) are from the placement. They are included as evidence of instructional practice, not as decoration. They are reproduced with the school's knowledge and are included solely for examination purposes; learner images are not for circulation beyond the examination process.



Figure 2.1: Delivering a Year 6 Computing lesson with Scratch in the school computer laboratory - evidence of instructional use of technology (see Section 4.4).



Figure 2.2: Whole-class teaching in a Year 6 classroom at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman - evidence of the physical setting described in Section 2.1.



Figure 2.3: The main school building of St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman - the site of the placement (see Section 2.1).



Figure 2.4: The administration block, from which the school's day-to-day operations are run.



Figure 2.5: The school's basketball court, part of the facilities available to learners outside the classroom (see Section 2.2).



Figure 2.6: With the Year 6 class and the university supervisor during a placement visit.



Figure 2.7: With the school's robotics team after placing first at CODEAVOUR 7.0, the national robotics competition the school enters annually; I was selected to join the team because I was teaching Computing at the school (see Sections 2.5 and 5.8).

2.5 Field experiences

I arrived with the usual mixture of excitement and apprehension. Teaching practice is the bridge between theory and the real classroom, and crossing it is never casual. The anxieties did not survive the first week. The staff received me warmly, Miss Ankomah took a genuine interest in my development, and the Year 6 learners, curious, energetic and direct, quickly made the room feel like a place I belonged.

Teaching two contrasting subjects stretched me in useful ways. In English I learned to slow down, to listen to how children actually use language, and to build lessons around genuine communication rather than isolated rules. Theme-based OIC work, including mystery and adventure reading, showed how a well-chosen context can pull reluctant readers and writers into a lesson. In Computing I discovered the opposite discipline:

precision. A Scratch project succeeds or fails on the clarity of its examples, and a missed event block means the whole program will not run. I learned to anchor abstract ideas in devices learners already know and to use the laboratory when machines were available and unplugged activity when they were not.

Two experiences stand out. The first was a listening-skills lesson, delivered with a purpose-built PowerPoint and realistic classroom scenarios, that held the class in attentive silence - a reminder that careful preparation is the truest form of classroom management. The second was less comfortable. Observation and analysis of learners' marks on School-Based Assessment 2 (SBA 2) showed that many learners could not confidently convert sentences between the active and passive voice, even though they could often identify a sentence as active or passive correctly. Rather than reteach and hope, I turned the problem into a systematic intervention. That work is the assessment centrepiece of this portfolio. It changed how I see teaching: a difficulty in the classroom is not an embarrassment; it is data.

The placement also carried me beyond the two subjects I was assigned. St. Martin De Porres enters a team each year for CODEAVOUR, a national robotics competition, and because I was teaching Computing at the school I was selected to join that year's team. We placed first. It was a useful reminder that the technology skills built in the Computing classroom (see Sections 3.6–3.8 and 3.12) extend naturally into co-curricular work, and that a subject teacher's contribution to a school is rarely confined to the timetable (see Figure 2.7 and the field-trip record in Section 5.8).

I left the practicum convinced of my calling. The teacher a child meets in Year 6 can shape not only what that child knows, but who that child believes they can become. That is a responsibility I accept.

CHAPTER THREE

PLANNING FOR INSTRUCTION

3.1 Lesson-plan writing

No builder raises a wall without a drawing, and no serious teacher enters a classroom without a plan. During the practicum I came to see the lesson plan not as an administrative burden but as the teacher's act of thinking in advance: deciding what learners should be able to do by the end of the lesson, how they will get there, what could go wrong, and how I will know they have arrived.

Plans followed the structure required by the school and the GES/NaCCA framework: the indicator or learning objective, core competencies, resources, a phased delivery (starter, main activities, plenary), differentiation, and assessment. For English under the OIC, each plan was aligned to the unit's intended outcomes and to the Knowledge-Understanding-Application progression. For Computing, plans emphasised demonstration and unplugged alternatives where devices were limited. A single plan often went through more than one draft. The discipline of drafting taught me to cut what was decorative and keep what caused learning.

Planning also taught humility. The best-laid plan meets real children, and no two lessons unfold identically. I learned to plan thoroughly and then hold the plan lightly, adjusting pace, re- explaining through a different example, or extending an activity that was clearly working. A lesson plan is a map, not a cage.

The portfolio contains twenty-one lesson plans grouped by unit and strand: the four-lesson grammar intervention and its materials (Sections 3.2–3.5), the four-lesson Scratch introduction (Sections 3.6–3.8), the featured narrative-writing lesson (Sections 3.9–3.10), the four-lesson PEEL writing sequence (Section 3.11), the eight-lesson

"From Algorithm to Program" Computing sequence (Section 3.12), and the listening-skills lesson (Section 3.13). Table 3.0 lists the lesson plans in chronological order using the dates shown on the individual plans. All listed lesson dates fall within the official practicum period of 1–25 June 2026; some dates include more than one lesson.

Table 3.0 Chronological index of the twenty-one lesson plans (official practicum period: 1–25 June 2026).

No.	Date	Week	Subject	Lesson title
1	Tue 2 Jun	Week 1	Computing	Meet Scratch: interface, sprites and motion
2	Wed 3 Jun	Week 1	English (grammar)	Understanding the basics of active and passive voice
3	Thu 4 Jun	Week 1	Computing	Events and loops
4	Fri 5 Jun	Week 1	English (grammar)	The four steps of transformation and tense application (best lesson)
5	Fri 5 Jun	Week 1	English (listening)	Listening for gist, detail and inference
6	Mon 8 Jun	Week 2	English (grammar)	Guided practice across tenses
7	Tue 9 Jun	Week 2	Computing	Looks and interaction
8	Wed 10 Jun	Week 2	English (grammar)	Advanced structures and reverse conversion

No.	Date	Week	Subject	Lesson title
9	Thu 11 Jun	Week 2	Computing	A mini project and practical assessment
10	Fri 12 Jun	Week 2	English (writing)	Introduction to PEEL paragraph structure
11	Mon 15 Jun	Week 3	Computing	From algorithm to program (counting loop)
12	Tue 16 Jun	Week 3	English (writing)	The 5W questioning system for supporting sentences
13	Wed 17 Jun	Week 3	Computing	Finding and fixing errors (debugging)
14	Thu 18 Jun	Week 3	English (writing)	The 'so what?' test and link sentences
15	Fri 19 Jun	Week 3	Computing	Decomposition (parts of a password generator)
16	Mon 22 Jun	Week 4	Computing	The initials program
17	Mon 22 Jun	Week 4	Computing	Arithmetic operations with variables
18	Tue 23 Jun	Week 4	English (writing)	Peer review and revision using 'two stars and a wish'

No.	Date	Week	Subject	Lesson title
19	Wed 24 Jun	Week 4	Computing	Adding ten numbers using loops
20	Thu 25 Jun	Week 4	Computing	Calculating the average of ten numbers (double period, part 1)
21	Thu 25 Jun	Week 4	Computing	Putting it together: the password generator (double period, part 2)

3.2 Unit plan: grammar - active and passive voice

Table 3.1 Scheme of work: active and passive voice (four-lesson intervention)

Week/lesson	Objective	Key activities	Assessment
1.1 (3 Jun)	Understand the basics of active and passive voice	Doer identification; the 'by zombies' test; sorting	Oral questioning
1.2 (5 Jun)	Learn the four steps of transformation and tense application	Four-step method; Tense Transformation Table; practice	Marked exercise
2.1 (8 Jun)	Guided practice across tenses	The Detective's Report passage; pair conversion	Observation; worksheets

Week/lesson	Objective	Key activities	Assessment
2.2 (10 Jun)	Advanced structures and reverse conversion	Agentless passives; perfect tenses; passive-to-active	Post-test (20 marks; separate 45-minute sitting after the lesson)

Table 3.2 Alignment with OIC assessment levels

OIC level	Grammar skill	When	Evidence
Knowledge (K)	Recognise active and passive voice	Lesson 1	Oral questioning; pre-test Part B
Understanding (U)	Explain the structural difference; name the tense	Lesson 2	Guided practice; worksheets
Application (A)	Convert between voices, preserving tense	Lessons 3-4	Post-test conversion items
Analysis (An)	Find and correct errors in conversion	Lessons 2-4	Error analysis; peer editing

The alignment in Table 3.2 follows the Knowledge-Understanding-Application progression of the OIC framework, in the spirit of Bloom's taxonomy and its revision (Bloom, 1956; Anderson & Krathwohl, 2001).

3.3 My best lesson plan

I have selected Lesson Plan 2, the four steps of transformation and tense application, as my best lesson. I chose it for three reasons. First, it targeted the actual gap the pre-test had measured, not a topic I merely wished to teach. Second, it made an invisible cognitive process visible: the four- step method and the Tense Transformation Table

reduced working-memory load so that pupils could perform a transformation they could not yet hold in their heads. Third, it used gradual

3.4 Four consecutive lesson plans from the intervention

Lesson Plan 1 - Understanding the basics of active and passive voice

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (grammar) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Wednesday 3 June 2026 | Week 1 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: define active and passive voice.
- Understanding: distinguish the doer from the receiver of the action in a sentence.
- Application: identify sentences as active or passive using the 'by zombies' test.

Resources: Sentence strips; whiteboard and markers; the 'by zombies' prompt card.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Greet; set objectives; ask pupils to identify the 'doer' in simple sentences	Respond; offer examples	Oral questioning

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Define active and passive voice and introduce the 'by zombies' test, modelling five examples on the board; distribute sentence strips for pupils to sort into active and passive in pairs, circulating to check reasoning; set ten further sentences for pupils to label individually or in twos.	Listen and question; sort sentence strips in pairs, justifying their choices to each other; then label ten sentences, working alone or checking answers with a partner.	Targeted questioning during modelling; observation and feedback during pair sorting; independent sentences collected for marking.
Plenary	5 min	Review; preview the four-step method	Exit ticket: label one sentence	Exit ticket

Support & Differentiation: Pair lower-attaining pupils with stronger peers for the sorting activity, and let them keep the sentence strips grouped by pattern as a visual aid. Challenge: Explain why a writer might choose the passive. Homework / Follow-up: Find three passive sentences in a short passage; underline the subject, verb and by-phrase.

Lesson Plan 2 - The four steps of transformation and tense application [selected as my best lesson plan]

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (grammar) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Friday 5 June 2026 | Week 1 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: state the four steps used to change active sentences into passive voice.
- Understanding: explain how the form of be matches the original tense.
- Application: convert simple active sentences into passive voice while preserving tense.

Resources: Tense Transformation Table (wall chart); four-step handout; sentence strips; whiteboard and coloured markers.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Revise Lesson 1 using the 'by zombies' test on five sentences	Respond	Oral questioning
Main	50 min	Display the four steps and the Tense Transformation Table, modelling three conversions; pupils then work in pairs to convert sentences with the chart visible, while I circulate to correct tense selection; finally, pupils complete ten further conversions individually or in pairs, with the chart gradually withdrawn as confidence grows.	Follow the modelling and question; convert sentences in pairs using the chart, discussing each step; complete further conversions, checking their own work or a partner's.	Checks after each modelled example; immediate correction during pair work; independent work reviewed, with peer review where pupils worked in pairs.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Plenary	5 min	Review hard items; restate the tense- preservation rule	Ask; copy the key rule	Worksheet collection

Support & Differentiation: Full use of the chart; partially completed sentence frames. Challenge: Perfect and future sentences with more complex auxiliaries. Homework / Follow-up: Five further conversions, each with a brief note of the steps followed.

Figure 3.1 Four-step conversion method displayed in the lesson

Step	What the pupil does
1	Identify the object in the active sentence and move it to the front (the new subject).
2	Add the correct form of be, matching the original tense.
3	Change the main verb to its past participle form.
4	Add by + the original subject (optional, but required in early practice).

Lesson Plan 3 - Guided practice across tenses

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (grammar) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Monday 8 June 2026 | Week 2 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Application: Apply the four-step method across simple, continuous and perfect tenses.
- Application: Identify active and passive sentences within a continuous passage.
- Application: Convert sentences of mixed tenses with decreasing reliance on the chart.

Resources: The Detective's Report passage; mixed-tense worksheet; Tense Transformation Table (wall chart).

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Brief recap for pupils who missed Lesson 2; restate the four steps	Listen; recall	Oral questioning
Main	50 min	Read The Detective's Report as a class and model finding active and passive sentences within the passage; lead ten oral conversions across different tenses in pairs, circulating to give immediate feedback; set a worksheet of mixed- tense conversions for pupils to complete individually or in pairs where extra support is needed.	Read along and identify sentences in the passage; convert sentences orally in pairs, naming the tense first; complete the worksheet, checking answers with a partner where helpful.	Targeted questions during the reading; observation and feedback during oral pair work; worksheet collected for marking.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Plenary	5 min	Review continuous and perfect items; preview agentless passives	Exit ticket	Exit ticket

Support & Differentiation: Tense chart on desk for the weaker pairs. Challenge: Convert a present-perfect sentence and explain the role of been.

Homework / Follow-up: Complete any unfinished conversions; write one conversion in the perfect tense.

Lesson Plan 4 - Advanced structures and reverse conversion

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (grammar) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Wednesday 10 June 2026 | Week 2 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Application: Convert sentences with an agentless passive (omitting by + doer).
- Application: Insert been correctly in perfect-tense passives.
- Application: Attempt the reverse conversion (passive to active), in preparation for the post-test administered in a separate sitting after the lesson.

Resources: Pronoun mini-table (I/me, he/him); perfect-tense examples.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Review; convert 'Someone stole my phone' as a class	Attempt; discuss	Oral questioning

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Explain agentless passives and the pronoun table, modelling how been is used in the perfect tense; lead reverse conversions (passive to active) in pairs, with immediate correction; consolidate the four-step method and the pronoun table through mixed practice.	Listen and note; convert sentences in pairs using the pronoun table; complete mixed practice individually.	Targeted questioning; immediate correction during pair work.
Plenary	5 min	Review agentless passives and pronoun case; preview the post-test	Reflect; ask final questions	Oral questioning

Support & Differentiation: Pronoun table available throughout. Challenge: Convert a sentence with a two-word verb or an indirect object.

Homework / Follow-up: None, in preparation for the post-test. Note: The 20-mark post-test was administered in a separate 45-minute sitting after Lesson 4, so that teaching time and testing time did not compete within a single period. The instrument and results are reported in Chapter Five.

3.5 Teaching and learning materials (grammar)

Grammar is often taught as an abstract set of rules that pupils memorise for examinations and promptly forget. In planning this unit I took the view that grammar becomes usable when it is made visible and physical. Five primary teaching and learning materials were designed for the intervention.

TLM 1 - Tense reference chart

A wall grid of the principal tenses (simple, continuous, perfect across past, present and future). Each cell held the tense name, active pattern, and an exemplar sentence. The chart remained on the board throughout Lessons 1–3 and was consulted during guided practice.

Table 3.3 Tense reference chart (as displayed)

Tense Category	Past	Present	Future
Simple	She wrote a letter. (Subject + V2)	She writes a letter. (Subject + V1/Vs)	She will write a letter. (Subject + will + V1)
Continuous	She was writing a letter. (was/were + V-ing)	She is writing a letter. (am/is/are + V-ing)	She will be writing a letter. (will be + V-ing)
Perfect	She had written a letter. (had + V3)	She has written a letter. (have/has + V3)	She will have written a letter. (will have + V3)
Perfect continuous	She had been writing a letter. (had been + V-ing)	She has been writing a letter. (have/has been + V-ing)	She will have been writing a letter. (will have been + V-ing)

TLM 2 - Passive-voice construction chart

A wall chart laying out the four steps and the be-auxiliary forms matching each tense, with colour-coded active and passive exemplar pairs.

Table 3.4 Active-to-passive conversion by tense (as displayed)

Tense	Active	Passive
Simple present	Sameer cleans the room.	The room is cleaned by Sameer.
Simple past	Sameer cleaned the room.	The room was cleaned by Sameer.
Present continuous	Sameer is cleaning the room.	The room is being cleaned by Sameer.
Past continuous	Sameer was cleaning the room.	The room was being cleaned by Sameer.
Present perfect	The mechanics have fixed the car.	The car has been fixed by the mechanics.
Simple future	The principal will deliver a speech.	A speech will be delivered by the principal.

TLM 3 and TLM 4 - Sentence strips and the "by zombies" test card

- TLM 3 (Sentence strips): Fifty laminated strips, each bearing a single active or passive sentence drawn from stories familiar to Year 6 pupils. Used in Lesson 1 for sorting into active and passive columns.
- TLM 4 (The 'by zombies' prompt card): A small prompt card showing the rule: 'If you can add by zombies after the verb and the sentence still makes grammatical sense, it is passive.' This mnemonic gave pupils an immediate self-check before formal transformation steps were introduced.

TLM 5 - Grammar reference booklet

An eight-page A5 booklet given to each pupil at the close of Lesson 4, containing the full tense-conversion table across simple, continuous and perfect tenses; the four-step conversion method; a table of common irregular past participles; ten practice items with an answer key; and a self-assessment checklist. The booklet's treatment of tense and voice drew on standard descriptive grammars (Biber et al., 2002; Celce-Murcia & Larsen-Freeman, 1999; Thornbury, 1999). It served as an aide-memoire for the post-test and allowed pupils to consult rules during independent practice.

Why these materials

Theoretical Foundations of Teaching and Learning Materials

Theory	**How it shaped the materials**
Vygotsky (1978) - zone of proximal development; Wood, Bruner and Ross (1976) - scaffolding	Charts and the handout were scaffolds inside pupils' ZPD: they could convert with help before they could convert alone.
Sweller (1988) - cognitive load	The chart held the formula outside working memory so pupils could attend to the swap itself.
Bloom (1956); Anderson and Krathwohl (2001) - taxonomy / OIC levels	Materials supported movement from identifying tenses, to explaining structure, to converting.
Ebbinghaus (1885) - forgetting curve	Daily reference to the same chart countered decay of tense knowledge taught in earlier years.

3.6 Unit plan: Computing - programming with Scratch

Alongside English Language, my practicum allocation included Year 6 Computing. The unit focused on block-based programming using Scratch 3.0, developing computational thinking through algorithms, sequences, selection, iteration, and variables.

Table 3.5 Scheme of work: Computing (programming with Scratch)

Week/lesson	Objective	Key activities	Assessment
1.1 (2 Jun)	Meet Scratch: interface, sprites and motion	Explore the editor; move a sprite; unplugged block cards	Observation; exit ticket
1.2 (4 Jun)	Events and loops	Green-flag event; repeat and forever; a walking sprite	Practical check
2.1 (9 Jun)	Looks and interaction	Say/think blocks; costumes; key-press events	Pair task; peer review
2.2 (11 Jun)	A mini project and practical assessment	Combine motion, events, loops and looks; practical test	Rubric (20 marks)

Table 3.6 Scratch practical-assessment rubric

Criterion	What it checks	Marks
Event	The program starts when the green flag is clicked	5
Motion	The sprite moves across the stage using motion blocks	5

Criterion	What it checks	Marks
Loop	A repeat or forever loop is used correctly	5
Looks	The sprite communicates using a say or think block	5
Total		20

3.7 Computing lesson plans

Lesson Plan 1 - Meet Scratch: the interface, sprites and motion

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Tuesday 2 June 2026 | Week 1 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: name the stage, sprite, blocks palette and script area.
- Understanding: explain that a program is a set of instructions carried out in order.
- Application: move a sprite across the stage using motion blocks.

Resources: Scratch editor on laboratory machines (or projector); unplugged block cards; interface diagram.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Greet; ask pupils to describe a 'program' in their own words	Respond; share ideas	Oral questioning

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Demonstrate the Scratch interface and model moving a sprite using motion blocks; pupils then work in pairs at the laboratory computers to move a sprite themselves, while I circulate to help with block order; finally, pupils make a sprite trace a square, working individually or in pairs where machines are shared.	Watch and note the parts of the interface; move a sprite in pairs, discussing the block order; then build the square-tracing script, working alone or sharing a machine.	Targeted questions during the demonstration; observation during pair work; each pupil's or pair's screen checked at the end.
Plenary	5 min	Review: what happens if blocks are in the wrong order?	Exit ticket: name the four parts	Exit ticket

Support & Differentiation: Unplugged block cards for pupils without a machine.

Challenge: Move the sprite using the turn block as well as move.

Homework / Follow-up: Draw and label the four main parts of the Scratch interface.

Lesson Plan 2 - Events and loops

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Thursday 4 June 2026 | Week 1 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: explain the purpose of the green-flag event block.
- Understanding: distinguish repeat (a fixed number) from forever (an endless loop).
- Application: build a sprite that walks across the stage when the green flag is clicked.

Resources: Scratch editor; a worked 'walking sprite' example; loop comparison cards.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Show a sprite that does not start; ask why	Diagnose the missing event	Oral questioning
Main	50 min	Model the green-flag event block, then the repeat and forever loops, contrasting the two; pupils work in pairs to add a green-flag event and a repeat loop to move a sprite, while I circulate to help build and test; pupils then choose repeat or forever for a walking sprite and justify their choice, working individually or checking with a partner.	Note the difference and question; build and test the script in pairs, correcting as they go; complete the independent task and review a partner's choice.	Targeted questions; observation and screen checks during pair work; peer review of the independent task.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Plenary	5 min	Review the repeat/forever difference	Exit ticket	Exit ticket

Support & Differentiation: Pre-built starter project with the sprite added.

Challenge: Use a forever loop with a say block inside it.

Homework / Follow-up: Write one sentence each explaining repeat and forever.

Lesson Plan 3 - Looks and interaction

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Tuesday 9 June 2026 | Week 2 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: name the say and think blocks and the costume tab.
- Understanding: explain how a key-press event makes a program interactive.
- Application: make a character speak when a key is pressed or when it reaches the edge.

Resources: Scratch editor; character sprite examples; key-press prompt card.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Show a character that 'talks'; ask how it was done	Predict	Oral questioning

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Model the say and think blocks, costumes, and the when-key-pressed event; pupils build in pairs, adding speech to a moving sprite triggered by a key press, while I circulate to observe; pupils then make the character speak when it reaches the edge of the stage, working individually or checking their screen with a partner.	Watch and note; build the interactive sprite in pairs; complete the independent extension and compare with a partner.	Targeted questions; observation during pair work; screen check of the independent task.
Plenary	5 min	Share two examples; note what makes them interactive	Present	Peer feedback

Support & Differentiation: Sentence starter cards for the speech text.

Challenge: Change costumes to make the character appear to walk.

Homework / Follow-up: Plan a short interactive sprite in three sentences.

Lesson Plan 4 - A mini project and practical assessment

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Thursday 11 June 2026 | Week 2 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: recall the blocks taught across the unit.
- Understanding: plan a short animation before building it.
- Application: build and test a program that combines an event, motion, a loop and a look block.

Resources: Scratch editor; the practical-assessment rubric; a sample animation for reference.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Set the task; display the rubric; show the sample	Listen; ask	Oral questioning
Main	40 min	Have pupils sketch their animation on paper before touching a machine, then circulate as they build and test their project at the computers, prompting where a pupil is stuck; this was run as a short coding practical, with the rubric visible throughout.	Plan the animation on paper first; build and test it in the laboratory, correcting as they go.	The paper plan checked before building starts; the finished project observed and scored against the rubric.
Plenary	5 min	Collect or screenshot the projects; celebrate two examples	Share	Rubric scoring

Support & Differentiation: A starter project for pupils who need the sprite set up for them. Challenge: Add a second sprite or a costume change.

Homework / Follow-up: Write two or three sentences on what was easiest and hardest in the practical.

3.8 Teaching and learning materials (Computing)

block cards and an interface diagram, so that pupils who could not hold the whole editor in their heads could still reason about a program before touching a machine.

- Scratch interface diagram: a large labelled poster of the stage, sprite list, blocks palette and script area.
- Unplugged block cards: laminated move, turn, say and repeat cards that pupils arranged on their desks to plan a program before building it.
- Worked examples: a 'walking sprite' and a 'talking character' opened on the projector so pupils could see a finished program and take it apart.
- Loop comparison cards: repeat (10) and forever shown side by side with a plain-language explanation of when each is used.

3.9 The wider Unit 7 context: narrative writing and drama

The active-and-passive-voice intervention documented in Sections 3.2 to 3.5 was one strand of a longer OIC Year 6 English unit, Unit 7: Spies and Mystery, which ran a reading, writing, speaking and grammar programme around detective and thriller fiction, built around the set text 'Botswana's Greatest Detective' from Oxford International English Student Book 6. Per the OIC Teacher's Guide, the unit's Week 8 sequence moves from punctuation and the handling of time (Lessons 1 and 2) into narrative writing (Lessons 3 to 5, 'Third-person narrative: an action thriller'), in which pupils examine effective opening lines, draft their own thriller openings, develop a hero,

a villain and a plot, and draft, peer-review and perform a complete story, working toward outcomes 6.6b, 6.6e, 6.6f and 6.6k.

I taught the narrative-writing strand of this sequence in parallel with the grammar intervention. Sections 3.10 and 3.11 present that lesson and the materials that supported it.

3.10 Featured lesson: the Action Thriller detective investigation

Unit title: Third-person narrative - the Action Thriller opening

- Subject: English Language (writing and narrative craft) | Class: Year 6 | Curriculum: OIC Unit 7, Week 8
- Duration: one 45-50 minute session ('The Hook Investigation'), the first of a four-session sequence
- Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Lesson objectives

- identify third-person narration in published thriller openings and explain why writers use it;
- explain how a strong opening creates a question in the reader's mind rather than answering one;
- identify powerful, sensory words that create tension;
- draft an original two-sentence thriller opening, in the third person, that creates a question and uses at least one powerful word. I built the lesson, delivered on slides, around a 'literary detective' framing. Pupils heard a ten- second sound cue (a ticking clock, then a door slam) and shared what they noticed; they were then told they were literary detectives whose mission was to find the pattern behind five published thriller openings (from Stormbreaker and Young Bond: Double or Die, plus further

openings written in the same style). Working from a detective sheet, they recorded who was narrating each opening, what question it created, what feeling it produced, and why they would keep reading.

The lesson's central teaching move was guided discovery rather than direct instruction. Rather than tell pupils that thriller writers use third-person narration, I asked a sequence of evidence- based questions - 'Who is telling us this story? Could you be the person in the scene? What words would change if the character was telling it?' - until pupils identified the pattern themselves: an outside, invisible narrator; a question left deliberately unanswered; and one powerful, chosen word. Only once they had found the pattern did I supply the term 'third-person narrative.' Pupils then wrote their own two-sentence thriller opening applying all three techniques, and volunteers read theirs to the class, which judged each one against the same three criteria.

I chose to lead with discovery rather than definition because the grammar intervention (Section 3.3) had already taught me that a rule pupils construct for themselves survives better than a rule they are handed. The lesson also built in differentiated pathways: a simplified 'Spy or Inside?' physical-response version for pupils needing heavier scaffolding, and an annotation challenge, marking up a professional opening for narration, verbs and structure, for pupils ready to analyse text unaided.

Supporting materials

- First Person and Third Person Writing Activities: a short warm-up establishing the two perspectives before the main investigation, with sorting, quiz and conversion exercises.

- Word Bank and Answer Key for Detective Sheet: a vocabulary toolkit (feelings words, a table of powerful words drawn from the five openings, sentence starters for each detective question) together with a full model answer key, which I used both to guide my questioning during the lesson and to assess pupils' completed detective sheets afterwards.
- Talking Points for Guided Discovery: a full script of the guided-discovery questioning sequence, an alternative simplified script for pupils who needed more scaffolding, and six differentiated homework extension activities - a real-world 'detective hunt,' a first-to-third- person transformation task, a weak-to-strong word upgrade, a question-writing task, a family 'detective test,' and a professional-text annotation challenge - with guidance on how to sequence them across the following weeks and assess them diagnostically rather than as simply right or wrong. Writing the guided-discovery script out in full before teaching it was itself useful preparation. It forced me to anticipate where pupils were likely to get stuck - confusing third person with the passive voice was one recurring confusion I planned a response to in advance, rather than improvising one in the moment.

3.11 Teaching and learning materials: paragraph writing (PEEL) - four lesson plans

Lesson Plan 10 - Introduction to PEEL paragraph structure

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (writing) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Fri 12 Jun 2026 | Week 2 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: name the four parts of PEEL (Point, Evidence, Explanation, Link).
- Understanding: explain the job each part does in holding a paragraph together.
- Application: label the four parts in a colour-coded model paragraph.

Resources: A colour-coded model paragraph displayed on the slide and printed on worksheets (topic: why reading matters); four highlighter colours (or four pencil patterns); a PEEL wall poster; sentence- starter cards.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Show a short paragraph whose sentences are in a muddled order. Ask what makes it hard to follow and what would put it right.	Read the muddled paragraph; discuss with a partner; identify that the ideas need an order.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Introduce the PEEL poster (10): define Point (the claim), Evidence (the proof), Explanation (why it matters), Link (where it leads), assigning a colour and a simple gesture to each. Model colour- coding a first paragraph on the slide, thinking aloud about why each sentence is P, E, E or L (10). Pupils then work in pairs to colour-code a second paragraph on their worksheets, justifying each choice to their partner (20). Review as a class; two pairs explain one colour choice each (10).	Follow the definitions; watch the modelling; colour-code the second paragraph in pairs; justify each choice; present one colour decision to the class.	Oral questioning during modelling; observation during pair coding; worksheets collected and checked.
Plenary	5 min	Recap the letters of PEEL and the job of each part. Preview the 5W questions that will generate evidence in the next lesson.	Chant back the four parts; name the colour and job of each.	Exit ticket: which colour marks the Point, and what does it do?

Support & Differentiation: A pre-segmented worksheet with the first sentence already coloured; pairing with a stronger reader; sentence starters for discussing choices ("This is Evidence because..."). Challenge: Explain why the Link is needed rather than ending on Explanation; suggest what the next paragraph after the model could be about.

Homework / Follow-up: Find one paragraph in any textbook or reader and label P, E, E and L lightly in pencil in the margin. Note: First of four PEEL lessons summarised in Section 3.11.

Lesson Plan 12 - The 5W questioning system for supporting sentences

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (writing) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Tue 16 Jun 2026 | Week 3 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: name the 5W questions (What, Where, Who, When, and How).
- Understanding: explain how 5W questions generate the supporting Evidence and Explanation
- sentences a paragraph needs.
- Application: use 5W questions to generate supporting sentences for a given Point.

Resources: 5W question cards or a dice; a sample Point on the board; the PEEL graphic organiser; a bank of sample paragraphs annotated to show which W generated each sentence.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Give a Point such as 'Breaktime is important at school'. Ask what a reader would still want to know; collect the question words pupils use on the board.	Suggest questions about the Point; notice that most begin with W words or 'How'.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Introduce the 5W prompt set (What, Where, Who, When, How) and show how each can become a supporting sentence (15); model generating three sentences from the starter Point, marking each as Evidence or Explanation. In pairs, pupils pick a 5W card and write a supporting sentence for a new Point on their organiser (20). Pairs share; the class judges whether each sentence is Evidence (something that happened or can be seen) or Explanation (why it matters) (10). Display an annotated sample paragraph to show the system in use (5).	Use the prompt cards; discuss and draft supporting sentences; classify sentences as Evidence or Explanation; compare choices with another pair.	The organiser is checked; targeted questions during circulation; one sentence per pair is collected.
Plenary	5 min	Ask which W produces the strongest evidence. Preview the 'so what?' test that turns evidence into explanation in the next lesson.	Vote and justify a choice; restate how a W becomes a sentence.	Exit ticket: one supporting sentence for a new Point, labelled with its W.

Support & Differentiation: Sentence frame 'The evidence is that ___ when ___'; word bank of useful verbs; pairing with a stronger writer. Challenge: Write one sentence that answers two W questions at once; turn an Explanation sentence into a stronger one by adding a concrete detail.

Homework / Follow-up: Choose one Point from a provided list and write four supporting sentences using four different W questions. Note: Second PEEL lesson; supports Section 3.11.

Lesson Plan 14 - The 'so what?' test and link sentences

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (writing) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Thu 18 Jun 2026 | Week 3 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: name three types of link sentence (back to the Point, forward to the next paragraph,
- broader significance).
- Understanding: explain how the 'so what?' test turns a piece of evidence into an explanation.
- Application: revise a weak explanation using 'so what?'; add a suitable link sentence to a paragraph.

Resources: Side-by-side weak and strong explanation examples; a link-sentence card with starters; a paragraph that stops after its Explanation and needs a Link; the whiteboard; pupils' homework sentences.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Write 'The test scores went up.' on the board and ask 'So what?' Press pupils to answer until the explanation says why that matters.	Answer the 'so what?' chain; feel how an explanation deepens with each answer.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Model the 'so what?' chain: evidence, why it matters, why the reader should care (10). In pairs, pupils take three pieces of evidence and apply the chain to write stronger explanations (20). Introduce the three link types with examples; pupils add a link to a paragraph that ends after its Explanation, choosing the link type that fits (15). Share and compare the different effects of the three link types (5).	Follow the modelled chain; revise weak explanations in pairs; choose and write a link; justify the link type chosen.	Revised explanations and links collected; observation; one link shared per pair.
Plenary	5 min	Recap that a complete paragraph answers four questions: what is your point, what proves it, why does it matter, and where next.	Restate the four questions a paragraph answers.	Exit ticket: one link- sentence starter they will use.

Support & Differentiation: Link starters ('This shows that...', 'As a result...', 'Looking ahead...'); a choice of two link types rather than three. Challenge: Write a link that connects to a next paragraph they predict; upgrade one explanation with a connective such as 'therefore' or 'however'.

Homework / Follow-up: Take the four supporting sentences from the previous homework and add a Point and a Link to make a complete PEEL paragraph.

Note: Third PEEL lesson; supports Section 3.11.

Lesson Plan 18 - Peer review and revision using 'two stars and a wish'

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (writing) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Tue 23 Jun 2026 | Week 4 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: recall the four PEEL rubric criteria (topic sentence, evidence, explanation, link).
- Understanding: explain why specific feedback helps a writer improve more than a mark alone.
- Application: peer-review a partner's paragraph using 'two stars and a wish'; revise their own
- paragraph in response.

Resources: The four-point PEEL rubric; 'two stars and a wish' feedback slips; pupils' own PEEL paragraphs from lessons 10-14; highlighters.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Compare a vague comment ('Good work') with a specific one ('Your evidence was strong; add a link back to the point'). Ask which helps a writer more.	Identify what makes feedback useful; note that a target beats a mark.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Walk through the rubric and model giving two stars (specific strengths) and one wish (a specific target) on a sample paragraph (10). Pairs swap paragraphs; each partner highlights P, E, E and L, completes the rubric, and writes two stars and a wish (20). Pupils then revise their own paragraph using the feedback, making at least one change to the Explanation or Link (15). Two volunteers read a before-and-after version; the class notes the improvement (5).	Apply the rubric; highlight the four parts; write specific feedback; revise their own paragraph; compare before and after versions.	Feedback slips and revised paragraphs are collected; rubrics scored; revision checked against feedback.
Plenary	5 min	Reflect on receiving feedback. Connect this to the feedback pattern used throughout the practicum: one strength, one target, and where possible a short model.	Name one change they made because of feedback and why it helps.	Exit ticket: one piece of feedback they acted on.

Support & Differentiation: Sentence starters for stars and the wish; a simplified checklist version of the rubric; a modelled feedback slip on the wall. Challenge: Review against all four criteria and suggest one vocabulary upgrade; rewrite the topic sentence to make it sharper.

Homework / Follow-up: Write the final revised paragraph neatly and submit it with the feedback slip attached. Note: Fourth PEEL lesson; uses the rubric and protocol described in Section 3.11.

3.12 Extended computing lesson sequence: from algorithm to program - eight lesson plans

Lesson Plan 11 - From algorithm to program

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Mon 15 Jun 2026 | Week 3 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: define an algorithm as a sequence of instructions; identify a variable, an event, a repeat-
- until loop and a sensing block in Scratch.
- Understanding: explain that a program is an algorithm carried out by the computer; explain why the
- count is one less than the number of values entered.
- Application: build a program that asks for numbers until X is entered and counts how many were
- entered.

Resources: Scratch on the laboratory computers and projector; unplugged block cards (when green flag, ask and wait, repeat until, change variable by, say); a pseudocode handout; the Scratch interface diagram.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Show a plain-language algorithm: ask for a number, keep asking until the user types X, and count how many numbers were entered. Ask pairs to act it out, one as the computer and one giving numbers, and predict the result if five numbers and then X are entered.	Act out the algorithm in pairs; predict the count; notice and explain any disagreement.	Oral questioning; predictions noted.
Main	50 min	Distinguish algorithm from program (5). Demonstrate building the program block by block (15): create a variable 'count' and set it to 0; under 'when green flag clicked', ask for a number or X to stop and wait; use a 'repeat until answer = X' loop containing 'change count by 1' and another ask; after the loop say how many numbers were entered. Pupils build in pairs at the computers, using unplugged cards first where machines are shared (20). Test with three numbers followed by X; lead the 'one less' discussion: X is the stop signal, not a counted value, so the count is one less than the number of entries (10).	Watch and question; arrange block cards to plan; build the script in pairs; test with sample data; explain why the count is one less; make corrections after feedback.	Targeted questions during demonstration; screen checks during the build; the completed script is checked for event, variable, loop and output.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Plenary	5 min	Ask what would happen if pupils forgot to set count to 0 at the start. Discuss; preview that next lesson pupils will fix planted bugs in this same program.	Predict the effect of the missing initialisation; name the four blocks used.	Exit ticket: name the four blocks and the purpose of the repeat-until loop.

Support & Differentiation: A starter project with the variable already created; unplugged cards to sequence before touching a machine; pairing with a more confident peer. Challenge: Modify the program so that it also sums the numbers entered, using a second variable.

Homework / Follow-up: Write the algorithm in plain English (3-5 steps) for a program that counts names until 'stop' is typed. Note: Links to NaCCA Computing Strand 5, indicator B6.5.1.1; constructionist learning by building (Papert, 1980). First lesson of the 'From Algorithm to Program' sequence described in Section 3.12.

Lesson Plan 13 - Finding and fixing errors (debugging)

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Wed 17 Jun 2026 | Week 3 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: name the three planted errors (wrong increment, missing initialisation, misplaced
- output).
- Understanding: explain how each error changes the program's behaviour.
- Application: trace a faulty program, locate the three bugs, and correct them so the count is accurate.

Resources: A deliberately buggy version of the Lesson 11 program pre-loaded on the laboratory computers; a 'bug report' worksheet with columns for Bug, Symptom and Fix; Scratch; the pseudocode handout.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Run the buggy program: enter five numbers and X, and show that it reports the wrong count. Ask whether the computer is wrong or the code is wrong.	Observe the surprising output; predict where the fault might lie.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Introduce debugging as finding and fixing errors, and model tracing a short loop by hand, one block at a time (5). Set the challenge: three bugs are planted (change count by 2 instead of 1; set count to 0 is missing; and the say block is inside the loop so the count shows every time). Pupils open the buggy project in pairs, trace it, locate and correct all three (25). They test to confirm the correct count and record each bug, its symptom and its fix on the bug-report sheet (15). Discuss how tracing systematically beats guessing (5).	Trace the loop by hand; test, locate and fix the three bugs; record symptoms and fixes; explain to a partner how each bug affected the output.	Observation and targeted questions; bug reports collected; corrected screens checked for the right count.
Plenary	5 min	Ask which bug was hardest to find and why. Introduce decomposition as the next strategy for managing larger programs.	Share one debugging strategy; name the three bugs.	Exit ticket: one tip for finding a bug.

Support & Differentiation: Hint cards naming the block near which each bug lives; pairing with a stronger peer; the pseudocode for reference. Challenge: Introduce a fourth bug of their own in a copy of the project and swap with another pair to find it.

Homework / Follow-up: On paper, write one line of faulty code (in simple pseudocode) and describe its symptom and fix. Note: Debugging is treated as a reasoning skill, not luck (Section 3.12).

Lesson Plan 15 - Decomposition (parts of a password generator)

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Fri 19 Jun 2026 | Week 3 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: define decomposition as breaking a problem into smaller, manageable parts.
- Understanding: explain why building and testing three small programs is safer than building one
- large one.
- Application: build and test three mini-programs: take the first letter of a word; generate a random
- number; join text and numbers.

Resources: Scratch; a decomposition planning sheet divided into Part A, B and C; unplugged block cards; a worked example on the projector.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Present the goal of building a password generator and ask pupils to list the smaller jobs it is made from. Collect ideas on the board.	Break the big goal into smaller jobs; suggest parts such as getting a letter and making a number.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Introduce decomposition and show the three-part plan (10): Part A takes the first letter of an entered word using 'letter 1 of answer'; Part B makes a random number using 'pick random 1 to 99'; Part C joins them with a 'join' block. Demonstrate Part A and have pupils build and test it (10); do the same for Part B (10); pupils then build Part C and test that the joined result appears, saving each part as a separate project (15). Stress that each part is tested before it is combined (5).	Follow the plan; build and test each mini-program in pairs; save parts separately; explain why testing each part helps.	Each part is screen- checked; planning sheets reviewed; testing observed.
Plenary	5 min	Ask why the three parts are saved separately. Tell pupils they will combine them into a full password generator in Lesson 21.	Explain the benefit of separate, tested parts; predict how the parts will combine.	Exit ticket: name the three parts and one Scratch block used in each.

Support & Differentiation: A starter project with the ask blocks already in place; block cards to arrange before building. Challenge: Add a third piece, such as a symbol or a second word, to the joined result.

Homework / Follow-up: Decompose 'make a sandwich' into at least five steps and note one step that could go wrong. Note: Decomposition is one of the three recurring ideas in the 'From Algorithm to Program' sequence (Section

Lesson Plan 16 - The initials program

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Mon 22 Jun 2026 | Week 4 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: identify the 'letter 1 of' operator and the 'join' block.
- Understanding: explain how two pieces of text are combined in the correct order.
- Application: write a program that asks for a first and last name and joins their first letters into a pair
- of initials.

Resources: Scratch; an initials planning card; a worked example on the slide ('Samuel Boateng' becomes 'SB').

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Show 'Akosua Mensah' becoming 'AM' on the board and ask how a computer could produce the initials.	Suggest steps such as taking the first letter of each name and putting them together.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Demonstrate asking for the first name and setting a variable 'firstInitial' to 'letter 1 of answer'; repeat for the last name (10). Show how to join the two initials with a 'join' block and say the result (10). Pupils build in pairs, test with their own names, and check that the initials appear in the right order (20). Two pairs demonstrate; discuss why order matters in a join (10).	Build the script; test with their own and a partner's name; correct the order if initials are swapped; explain their program to another pair.	Screen checks during the build; a completed initials program is the exit check.
Plenary	5 min	Ask what would change to use the last letter of each name instead. Preview this as an extension in Lesson 21.	Predict the change from 'letter 1 of' to 'last letter of'; state what the join block does.	Exit ticket: the two blocks that make the initials.

Support & Differentiation: A starter project with the two ask blocks and variables already set up. Challenge: Add a dot between the initials (S.B.) using a nested join, or append a random number.

Homework / Follow-up: Write the pseudocode for the initials program in four or five lines. Note: Reuses the 'letter 1 of' and 'join' blocks introduced in Lesson 15.

Lesson Plan 17 - Arithmetic operations with variables

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Mon 22 Jun 2026 | Week 4 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: name the four arithmetic operator blocks (+, -, x, /).
- Understanding: explain that a variable can hold a number entered by the user and be used in a
- calculation.
- Application: build a program that asks for three numbers and displays their total.

Resources: Scratch; a calculator-planning worksheet; the projector for modelling.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Write three numbers on the board and ask for their total. Ask how a program would work out the same total.	Calculate mentally; describe the steps of adding three numbers.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Show that 'ask and wait' returns text Scratch can treat as a number; create three variables n1, n2, n3 (10). Demonstrate setting each from three asks, then setting 'total' to n1 + n2 + n3 using operator blocks, and saying the result (10). Pupils build in pairs and test with 2, 3, 5 (expect 10); circulate and draw out the common error of using a variable before it is set (20). Pupils who finish extend the program to show the product n1 x n2 x n3 (10).	Create and set variables; build the calculation; test with given values; find and fix order errors; attempt the product extension.	Screen checks during the build; an exit calculation is checked for the correct total.
Plenary	5 min	Ask what happens if the user types a word instead of a number. Introduce input validation as a future idea.	Predict the fault; restate the rule that a variable must be set before it is used.	Exit ticket: the value of total for inputs 4, 6 and 10.

Support & Differentiation: A starter project with the three variables created; pairing with a confident peer. Challenge: Ask the user how many numbers they want to add (up to five) and adapt the program.

Homework / Follow-up: Predict the output of a given three-number program shown on a worksheet, showing the arithmetic. Note: Taught as the second half of a double period with Lesson 16 on Monday 22 June, to fit the twenty-one lessons into the June 1-25 weekday block. Prepares the arithmetic used in Lessons 19 and 20.

Lesson Plan 19 - Adding ten numbers using loops

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Wed 24 Jun 2026 | Week 4 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: identify the 'repeat' loop and the running-total pattern.
- Understanding: explain why one loop replacing ten repeated input blocks reduces mistakes.
- Application: build a program that asks for ten numbers using a repeat loop and displays their sum.

Resources: Scratch; a loop-planning sheet; a slide comparing ten repeated ask blocks against one loop.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Show a long script made of ten repeated ask-and-add blocks. Ask what is wrong with writing it that way.	Criticise the long script: repetitive, long, easy to mistype, hard to change.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Introduce the running total: set 'total' to 0, then 'repeat 10' asking for a number and changing total by the answer (10). Demonstrate, deliberately revisiting the missing-initialisation bug from Lesson 13 (10). Pupils build in pairs and test with the numbers 1 to 10, expecting 55; circulate and check that the loop contains both the ask and the change block (20). Compare the loop's length to the ten-block version and discuss reuse in the next lesson (10).	Build the loop; initialise total; test with 1 to 10; find errors when the total is wrong; explain why the loop is shorter and safer.	Screen checks during the build; an exit value of 55 confirms the program works.
Plenary	5 min	Ask how to change the program for 100 numbers. Preview averaging the total in Lesson 20.	Answer that you change 10 to 100; restate the running-total pattern.	Exit ticket: the two blocks that must be inside the loop.

Support & Differentiation: A pseudocode handout; a starter project with the total variable created. Challenge: Count how many of the ten numbers are over 50, using an 'if' block inside the loop.

Homework / Follow-up: Write the loop version of the program in pseudocode, underlining the initialisation line. Note: Reuses tested code; prepares Lesson 20 (Section 3.12).

Lesson Plan 20 - Calculating the average of ten numbers

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Thu 25 Jun 2026 | Week 4 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: recall that average equals total divided by count.
- Understanding: explain why reusing the tested Lesson 19 script is better than starting over.
- Application: reuse the Lesson 19 total script and add blocks to divide the total by ten and display the
- average.

Resources: Scratch; the pupils' saved Lesson 19 projects; an average prompt card.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Ask pupils: if ten numbers sum to 55, what is their average? Have pupils calculate mentally.	Compute 55 divided by 10 = 5.5; recall the average formula.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Have pupils open their saved Lesson 19 projects and confirm that the total already works (5). Demonstrate adding 'set average to total / 10' after the loop and saying the result (10). Pupils add these blocks to their existing scripts and test with 1 to 10, expecting 5.5; circulate (20). Discuss reuse: they changed only what was new instead of rebuilding the whole loop, which reduces mistakes (15).	Open the saved project; confirm the total; add the division and output; test; explain the value of reusing tested code.	Screen checks; an exit average of 5.5 for inputs 1 to 10.
Plenary	5 min	Ask why the divisor is 10 and not 9. Note that this lesson and Lesson 21 were taught as a double practical period.	Explain that 10 values were entered; state one advantage of reuse.	Exit ticket: the average of 2, 4, 6, 8 and 10 (6).

Support & Differentiation: Pair with a pupil who completed Lesson 19; a prompt card showing 'average = total / count'. Challenge: Replace the fixed 10 with a 'count' variable so the program works for any number of entries. Homework / Follow-up: Given three totals and counts on a worksheet, calculate the three averages. Note: Taught as the first half of a double period with Lesson 21; illustrates reuse (Section 3.12).

Lesson Plan 21 - Putting it together: the password generator

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: Computing | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Thu 25 Jun 2026 | Week 4 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: recall the three parts from Lesson 15 and the 'letter 1 of', 'pick random' and 'join' blocks.
- Understanding: explain how the decomposed parts combine into one working program.
- Application: combine the three Lesson 15 parts into a working password generator and attempt at
- least one extension.

Resources: Scratch; the pupils' three saved Lesson 15 parts; a challenge card; a four-criterion practical rubric (first letter, random number, join, working output) parallel to Table 3.6.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Show a finished password such as 'K47' made from the word 'Kofi' and a random number. Recap the three parts built in Lesson 15.	Name the three parts and the block each part uses.	Oral questioning.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Main	50 min	Pupils plan the combination on paper first, sketching which saved part connects to which (5). They then build: under 'when green flag clicked', ask for a word, set the first letter, set a random number, join them and say the result, testing as they go (20). Pupils choose at least one extension: use the last letter instead of the first; add a second random number to lengthen the password; or add a conditional check comparing a value against a class average from Lesson 20 (15). Finished projects are collected or screenshotted and scored against the rubric (10).	Plan on paper; connect the three saved parts; test and debug; attempt an extension; save and present the working program.	Paper plan checked before building; finished project scored against the four-criterion rubric.
Plenary	5 min	Celebrate two or three examples; reflect briefly on the journey from Lesson 11 (a simple counting loop) to Lesson 21 (a planned, decomposed, tested program).	Share one thing they learned across the eight lessons; name one debugging strategy they will reuse.	Final practical scored; pupil reflection collected.

Support & Differentiation: A starter project with the three parts already built, leaving pupils to connect them in order. Challenge: Complete two extensions; add a costume change or 'say' greeting to make the output interactive.

Homework / Follow-up: Write two or three sentences: which of the eight Computing lessons was hardest, and what finally made it click. Note: Capstone of the 'From Algorithm to Program' sequence; assessed with a rubric parallel to the Scratch practical rubric in Table 3.6. Taught as the second half of a double period with Lesson 20.

3.13 Listening-skills lesson

Listening is the foundation of spoken and written English, yet it is rarely taught systematically. Lesson Plan 5 documents a 60-minute listening lesson designed around an audio mystery narrative, developing skills in listening for gist, extracting specific detail, and making inferences from tone and context.

Lesson Plan 5 - Listening for gist, detail and inference

Teacher: Samuel Kwabena Boateng | School/class: St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman | Year 6 | Subject: English Language (listening) | Duration: 60 minutes | Date: Fri 5 Jun 2026 | Week 1 | Mentor: Miss Angela Ankomah

Learning Objectives:

- Knowledge: identify key vocabulary from the audio (announce, passenger, platform, delay,
- mumbled).
- Understanding: distinguish the gist of a spoken text from its specific details; infer a speaker's
- feeling from tone and context.
- Application: complete gist, detail and inference questions while listening to a short recorded
- scenario.

Resources: Purpose-built PowerPoint; a short audio clip of a realistic scenario (a station announcement followed by a short traveller dialogue) played through

speakers and the projector; a listening worksheet with pre-, while- and post-listening sections; pencils; a small whiteboard for note-taking modelling.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Starter	5 min	Display an image of a busy bus or railway station on the slide. Ask pupils to predict what they might hear and to suggest three key words they expect to listen for. Record predictions on the board.	Look at the image; predict the setting and likely words; share ideas with a partner before volunteering.	Oral questioning; predictions recorded.
Main	50 min	Pre-listening (10): pre-teach five key words with pictures and quick examples; set a gist question: where are the people and what is happening? First play (8): play the clip once for gist; take no written answers yet. Second play (12): pupils answer five detail questions (times, places, names) while listening; model a simple note-taking layout on the board. Third play (15): pupils answer two inference questions about how the speaker feels and how they know; draw out clues in tone, volume and wording. Feedback (5): review answers and model how to phrase an inference using evidence from the audio.	Repeat key words; listen for gist and compare with a partner; take brief notes during the second play; answer detail questions; listen a third time for feeling and clues; discuss and justify inferences before writing final answers.	Worksheet collected; targeted questioning during feedback; one inference answer shared per pair.

Stage	Time	Teacher activity	Pupil activity	Assessment
Plenary	5 min	Ask which clue told pupils how the speaker felt. Reinforce that good listeners listen for feelings, not only words. Preview the next lesson.	Identify one clue (a word or a tone); name one new word learned today.	Exit ticket: one new word and its meaning.

Support & Differentiation: Key words are pre-listed with meanings; questions are read aloud before playing; pupils discuss in pairs before writing; a sentence frame is provided for inference ("I think the speaker feels ___ because the audio says ___"). Challenge: Write a one-sentence summary of the clip in their own words; identify one additional clue not discussed by the class; predict what might happen next in the scenario.

Homework / Follow-up: Listen to a news announcement, a radio segment or a conversation at home and note the gist and one specific detail to share in the next lesson. Note: This is the listening-skills lesson referenced in Section 2.5, delivered with a purpose-built PowerPoint and realistic classroom scenarios.

CHAPTER FOUR

INCLUSIVE, RESPONSIVE AND TECHNOLOGY-RICH TEACHING

4.1 Adapting instruction for learners with special educational needs

Inclusion, for me, began with the conviction that a learning difficulty is a difference in how a child learns, not in whether a child can learn. Ghana's Persons with Disability Act, 2006 (Act 715) and the NaCCA standards-based curriculum both require that instruction be accessible. In my Year 6 class I did not have formally diagnosed cases on file. I did have observable, consistent needs: difficulty sustaining attention across a sixty-minute lesson, slowness in processing multi-step oral instructions, and fatigue on dense print. Those observations, not invented labels, drove the adaptations.

- Seating: learners who needed monitoring sat near the board and away from the door and windows.
- Print and slides: larger, high-contrast text; tasks chunked into numbered steps, with a check after each step.
- Time and mode: extra time on written tasks; oral responses accepted where writing was the barrier rather than the learning.
- Peer support: a buddy system in which stronger readers supported classmates in independent work.
- Computing: demonstrate first, try in pairs, then try alone, so that no learner faced the machine anxious and isolated. The numbered steps, the enlarged visuals and the buddy system lifted confidence beyond the pupils I had originally had in mind. That is the usual lesson of inclusive design: adjustments made for a few are often better teaching for all. I also know the limit of what the practicum can teach. Supporting

a child with a specific diagnosed disability requires specialised knowledge I do not yet have. I record that as a growth area, not as a claim of expertise.

Table 4.1 records the observed needs and the corresponding adaptations and outcomes.

Observed need Specific adaptation Evidence / outcome Difficulty sustaining attention across a 60-minute lesson Seating near the board; chunked tasks with a check after each step; short movement transitions Longer on-task stretches during main activity; fewer interruptions during modelling

Table 4.1 Observed needs, adaptations and outcomes

Observed need	Specific adaptation	Evidence/outcome
Difficulty sustaining attention across a 60-minute lesson	Seating near the board; chunked tasks with a check after each step; short movement transitions	Longer on-task stretches during main activity; fewer interruptions during modelling
Slowness processing multi-step oral instructions	Instructions repeated in different words; numbered steps on the board/slide; buddy to confirm	Fewer 'what do I do?' questions once steps were visible
Fatigue on dense print	Larger high-contrast text; more white space; oral responses accepted where writing was the barrier	More questions attempted; completed worksheets increased
Anxiety around independent computer work	Demonstrate-pair-try routine; unplugged planning before touching a machine	All pupils attempted the Scratch practical; one low performer identified for follow-up

4.2 Adapting instruction for English language learners

My Year 6 pupils came to school speaking Ga, Twi, Ewe and other Ghanaian languages at home. English was for many of them a second or third language, learned largely inside school walls. Language support was therefore a permanent layer of planning, not an occasional adaptation, in line with scaffolded approaches to teaching second-language learners in mainstream classrooms (Gibbons,, 2002; Lightbown & Spada, 2013).

- Vocabulary first: word walls and picture support for terms such as suspect, evidence, tense, auxiliary, participle, subject and object.
- Sentence frames: 'I can infer that ... because the text says ...'; 'This sentence is passive because ...'.
- Worked examples before independent attempts.
- Colour-coding of subject, verb and object so that pupils could see the swap the passive requires, not merely hear a rule about it.
- Brief, purposeful use of the home language to unlock a concept, then a return to English to express it - translanguaging as a bridge, not a substitute.
- Teacher-talk: slower pace, instructions repeated in different words, and frequent checks.

A recurring interference pattern was the confusion of passive voice with the past tense, understandable in learners whose home languages mark time and voice differently from English. Lesson 1 had to address that misconception directly. Language, I learned, is the medium every other subject travels through. When I taught the language carefully, everything else travelled better.

4.3 Teaching learners from diverse cultures and ethnic backgrounds

Dansoman is one of Accra's more cosmopolitan suburbs. Although it sits in the Ga homeland, the classroom gathered children of Ga, Akan, Ewe, Dagomba and other heritages, from Christian and Muslim homes, and from a wide range of family circumstances. I treated that diversity as a teaching resource, in the spirit of culturally responsive teaching (Gay, 2010).

- Names in examples, word problems and practice sentences reflected the range of Ghanaian names in the room.
- When a mystery or report-writing context needed a setting, we used markets, trotro stations, compound houses and festival scenes alongside any international setting in the scheme, so that learners' own world counted as literature.
- Home languages were objects of curiosity rather than embarrassment. Comparing how Ga or Twi expresses an idea that English expresses differently proved a surprisingly powerful way to teach English grammar consciously.
- Talk about festivals, foods and faith was framed with respect. Group work was watched so that friendship groups did not quietly harden into ethnic groups. Cultural responsiveness, I concluded, is mostly a habit of noticing: who is represented in your examples, who speaks in your discussions, and whose experience your lesson treats as normal.

4.4 Instructional use of technology

A teacher who notices can include. A teacher who does not will exclude without intending to.

Technology featured in two roles: as a subject I taught, and as a tool I taught with. The governing rule was the same in both cases. Technology must earn its place. A slide

that merely decorates is a distraction. A diagram that makes the invisible visible - the flow of a control system, the skeleton of a passive sentence, the order of blocks in a program - is worth the preparation.

As a subject, I taught Year 6 Computing, including the Scratch programming unit documented in Sections 3.6 to 3.8 (Figure 2.1). Abstract ideas were first acted out or drawn, then identified in real devices, then, where machines allowed, built on screen. Unplugged block cards kept the lesson intact when device access was uneven.

As a tool, I used PowerPoint for the listening-skills lesson, a projector for shared reading and modelled writing, audio for listening comprehension, and ordinary word-processing to produce differentiated worksheets and the action-research instruments. The two grammar wall charts were analogue technology, and they did more cognitive work than most of the slides.

CHAPTER FIVE

ASSESSMENT AND THE ACTION-RESEARCH PROJECT

5.1 Identifying the problem

Bridging the knowledge-understanding gap in grammar instruction: using scaffolded tense review to improve Year 6 pupils' ability to convert between active and passive voice.

Routine classwork, and then the school's School-Based Assessment 2 (SBA 2), taken by all 21 pupils in Week 1, showed a consistent pattern. Pupils could often label a sentence as active or passive. Most could not accurately transform one into the other. Scripts showed recurring errors: omission or wrong choice of the auxiliary be; failure to use the past participle of the main verb; loss of the original tense during conversion; and confusion over the placement of the doer in the by-phrase.

The difficulty did not come from ignorance of the words 'active' and 'passive'. It came from shallow or forgotten knowledge of tenses, the structural prerequisite for conversion. Grammar is cumulative. Forgotten foundations block higher-order application. Identification at 93.3 per cent against conversion at 44.8 per cent is a gap of 48.5 percentage points between knowing a label and doing the work.

5.2 The intervention

Over four 60-minute lessons I implemented an intervention built on explicit, visual and practice- rich instruction (Thornbury, 1999; Ellis, 2006):

- the four-step conversion method, rehearsed aloud before it was written;
- the Tense Transformation Table, which made the tense-dependent choice of be visible;

- colour-coding of subject, verb and object so that pupils could see the swap;
- tense-anchoring drills: name the tense of the active sentence, then keep it in the passive;
- guided pair practice on a continuous passage (The Detective's Report);
- gradual withdrawal of the wall charts;
- a final lesson on agentless passives, perfect tenses and the reverse conversion.

The design follows the logic of action research as a cycle of observe, diagnose, act and reflect (Kemmis and McTaggart, 1988). It is a classroom cycle, not a laboratory experiment. There is

5.2 The intervention

The class mean on the target active-to-passive conversion skill increased from 2.24/5 (44.8%) before the intervention to 4.57/5 (91.4%) afterwards. This is an increase of 2.33 marks out of five, equivalent to 46.6 percentage points. Nineteen of the 21 pupils (90.5%) improved, while two (9.5%) remained unchanged and none declined, according to the class-level results recorded in Table 5.3. These are descriptive findings: the post-test used new sentences, there was no comparison group, and the individual paired scores needed to verify a paired-samples t-test were not available for independent checking. For that reason, the earlier t(20) and p-value claim has been removed. The results show improvement after the intervention, but they do not prove that the intervention alone caused it.

5.3 Instruments

The pre-test was the school's School-Based Assessment 2, a 20-mark paper in three sections. Section A (10 marks) was a multiple-choice cloze testing vocabulary in context; Section B (5 marks) required pupils to identify isolated sentences as active or

passive; Section C (5 marks) required pupils to transform five active sentences into passive voice across different tenses. Section C provided the baseline measure of the target skill.

Pre-test sample items

- Section A (format): a cloze passage with four options (A-D) for each gap.
- Section B: 'The floor has been cleaned by the janitor.' (active or passive?); 'Ama sings

5.3 Instruments

Duduke.' (active or passive?)

- Section C: 'The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.' to passive; 'I have found Adidza's bag.' to passive. The post-test was a 20-mark paper written under a 45-minute limit, administered in a separate sitting after Lesson 4. It was not a clone of the SBA: only Section B repeated the SBA's target skill with new sentences, and this matched pair provided the primary outcome measure. Section A (10 marks) required pupils to identify five active and five passive clauses inside a continuous passage, a harder task than the pre-test's isolated sentences. Section B (5 marks) required five active-to-passive transformations, the same skill as the pre-test Section C. Section C (5 marks) introduced a new skill taught in the final lesson: five passive-to-active transformations. The live items are not reproduced here so that the paper remains usable in the same school.

5.4 Results Section Skill tested Mean Percentage A (/10) Vocabulary in context (cloze) 7.19 71.9% B (/5) Identify active or passive voice 4.67 93.3% C (/5) Transform active sentences into passive voice 2.24 44.8% Total (/20) 14.10 70.5%

Table 5.1 Pre-test results (n = 21)

5.4 Results

Score range Pupils Share Interpretation 0-1 6 28.6% Very weak 2-3 11 52.4% Weak 4 3 14.3% Average 5 1 4.8% Excellent

Table 5.1 Pre-test results (n = 21)

Section	Skill tested	Mean	Percentage
A (/10)	Vocabulary in context (cloze)	7.19	71.9%
B (/5)	Identify active or passive voice	4.67	93.3%
C (/5)	Transform active sentences into passive voice	2.24	44.8%
Total (/20)		14.10	70.5%

Pre-test Score Range Distribution (Section C)

Score range	Pupils	Share	Interpretation
0-1	6	28.6%	Very weak
2-3	11	52.4%	Weak
4	3	14.3%	Average
5	1	4.8%	Excellent

vocabulary (Section A) and conversion (Section C) was negligible (r = 0.03), and between identification and conversion only moderate (r = 0.48). Full individual scores, the marking scheme and the analysis appear in the accompanying action research report.

Identification of isolated sentences was already secure before the intervention (93.3%) and was not retested in the same format; the post-test instead assessed identification inside a continuous passage, a harder and non-equivalent task. The reverse-conversion

skill, taught and assessed once, reached 72.0%; this is an initial result, not evidence of mastery. The primary comparison is active-to-passive conversion: the class mean rose from 2.24/5 (44.8%) on the pre-test to 4.57/5 (91.4%) on the post-test. Because the questions were different and no control group was used, this change should be interpreted as a descriptive improvement following the intervention, rather than conclusive proof of causation.

Table 5.2 Post-test results (n = 21)

Section	Skill tested	Mean	Percentage
A (/10)	Identify active and passive clauses in a passage	7.71	77.1%
B (/5)	Transform active into passive voice	4.57	91.4%
C (/5)	Transform passive into active voice (new skill)	3.60*	72.0%*
Total (/20)		15.88	79.4%

Table 5.3 Pre-test versus post-test comparison (matched conversion)

Indicator	Pre-test (SBA C)	Post-test (Section B)	Change
Class mean	2.24 (44.8%)	4.57 (91.4%)	+2.33 (+46.6 pp)
Pupils scoring 0	3	0	-3
Pupils scoring full marks	1 (4.8%)	15 (71.4%)	+14
Pupils scoring 4 or 5	4 (19.0%)	19 (90.5%)	+15
Pupils who improved	-	19 (90.5%)	-
Pupils unchanged	-	2 (9.5%)	-

Indicator	Pre-test (SBA C)	Post-test (Section B)	Change
Pupils who declined	-	0	-

so part of the gain could reflect item difficulty; and the floor effect at baseline means the three pupils who scored zero could only stay the same or improve.

Anonymised sample scripts are reproduced immediately below, labelled as previously low, average and high performers by score.

Twenty-one anonymised sample scripts follow, one per pupil in the class, drawn from the diagnostic instrument's Section B (identifying active and passive voice, items 11-15) and Section C (transforming active sentences into passive voice, items 16-20) reported in Table 5.1. Each image has been cropped to remove the pupil's name and the date written at the top of the sheet; only the marked exercise itself is shown. Scores visible on the originals span the same range summarised in Table 5.1 (overall totals from

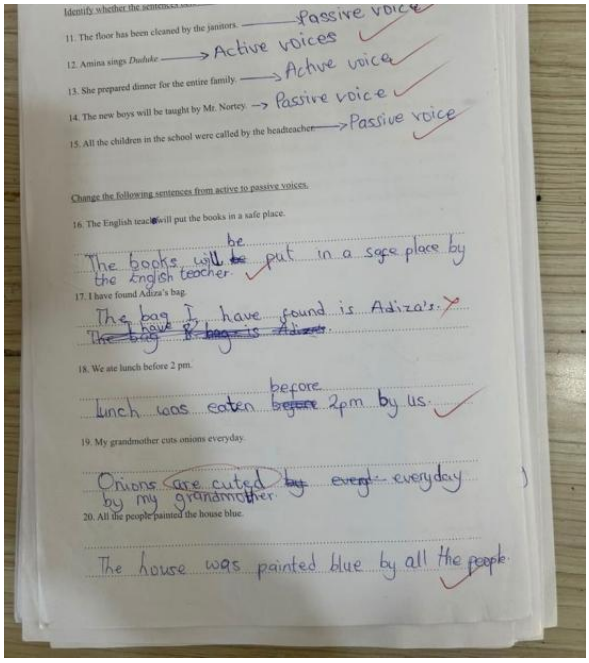
5.5 Learners' work as a give-and-take relationship

8 to 18 out of 20; conversion scores in Section C from 0 to 5), so the set includes previously low, average and high performers. Matching post-test scripts for the same cohort were not retained as photographs during the placement and so are not reproduced here; Tables 5.2 and 5.3 report the post-test results at the class level.

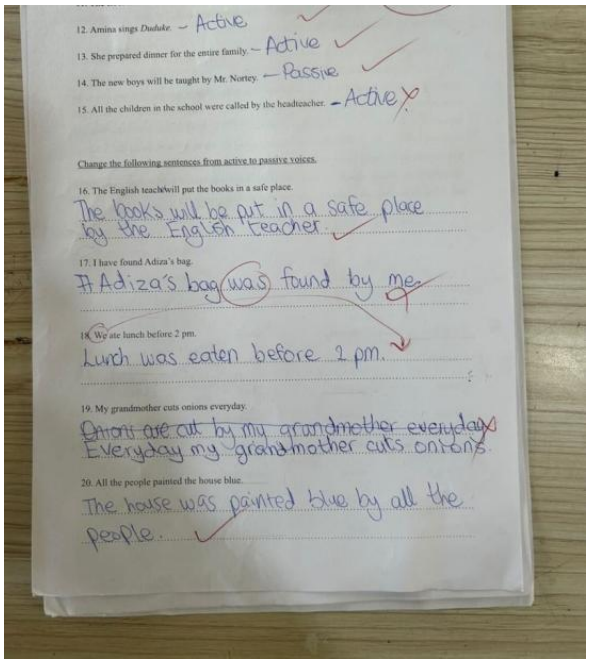
Diagnostic Scripts: Twenty-One Anonymised Pre-Test Papers (Figure 5.1)

Figure 5.1 reproduces the twenty-one marked pre-test scripts referenced in Table 5.1. Each script shows the pupil's working across Sections A, B and C, illustrating the diagnostic patterns discussed in Section 5.1.

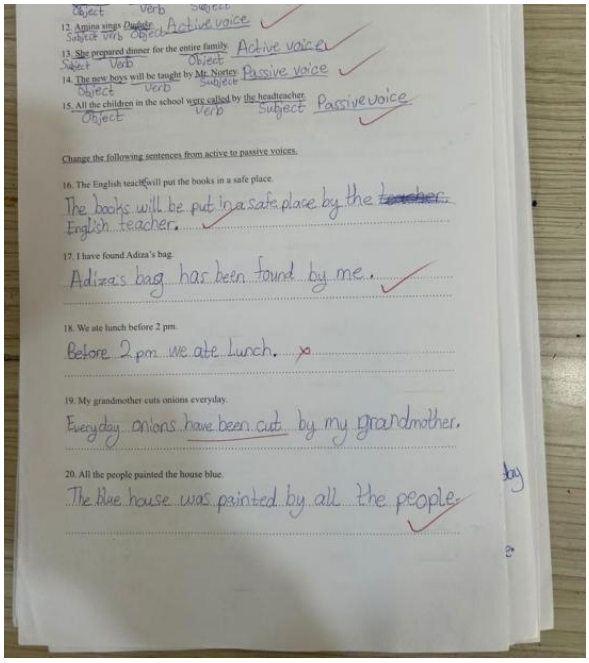
Sample script 1 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 1)



Sample script 2 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 2)



Sample script 3 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 3)



12. Amina sings *Dudukɔ*. Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the ~~teacher~~ English teacher.

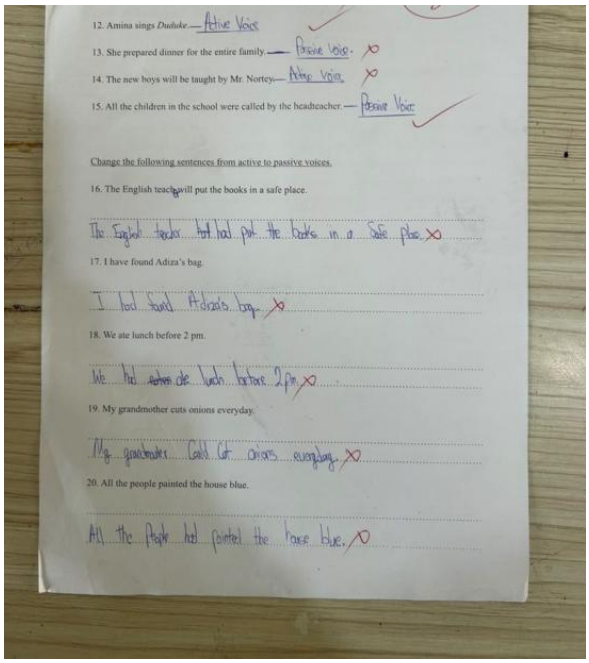
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2 pm we ate lunch.

19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday onions have been cut by my grandmother.

20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue house was painted by all the people.

Sample script 4 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 4)



12. Amina sings *Dudukɔ*. — Active Voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. — Passive Voice.
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. — Active Voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. — Passive Voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The English teacher had had put the books in a safe place.

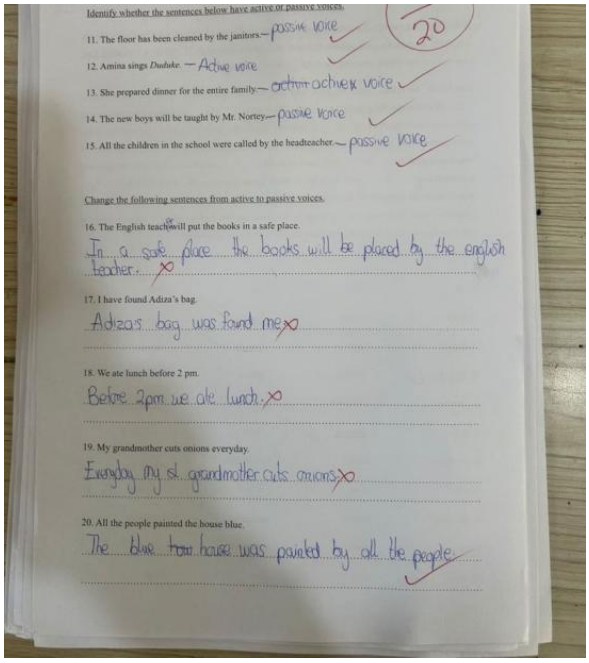
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
I had found Adiza's bag.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
We had ~~eaten~~ ate lunch before 2pm.

19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
My grandmother could Cut onions everyday.

20. All the people painted the house blue.
All the People had painted the house blue.

Sample script 5 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 5)



Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

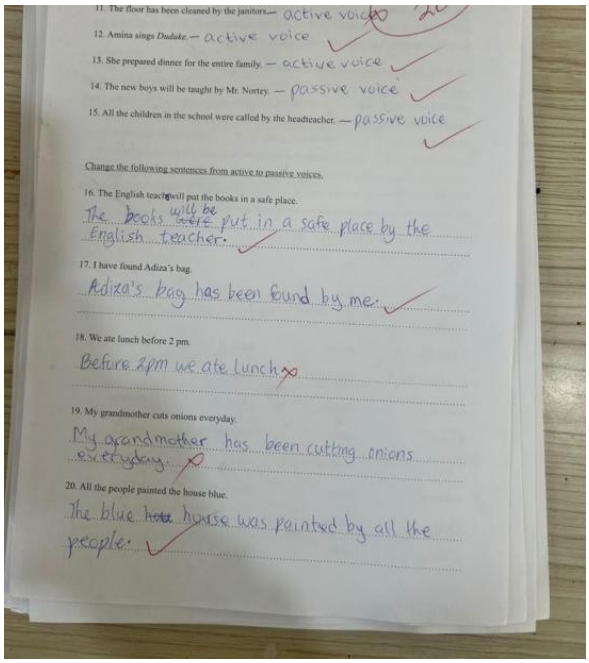
11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors.— passive voice ✓
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. — Active voice ✓
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family.— ~~actrm~~ active voice ✓
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey— passive voice ✓
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher.— passive voice ✓

20

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
In a safe place the books will be placed by the english teacher. ✗
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adizas bag was found me ✗
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we ate lunch. ✗
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my st. grandmother cuts onions ✗
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue ~~hou~~ house was painted by all the people ✓

Sample script 6 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 6)

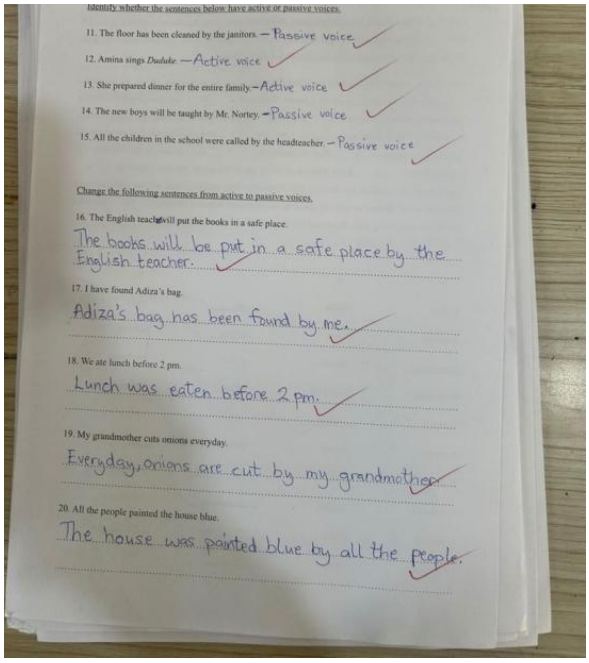


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors.— active voice
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. — active voice ✓
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. — active voice ✓
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. — passive voice ✓
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. — passive voice ✓

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be ~~safe~~ put in a safe place by the English teacher. ✓
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me. ✓
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we ate lunch ✗
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
My grandmother has been cutting onions everyday ✗
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue ~~hou~~ house was painted by all the people. ✓

Sample script 7 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 7)



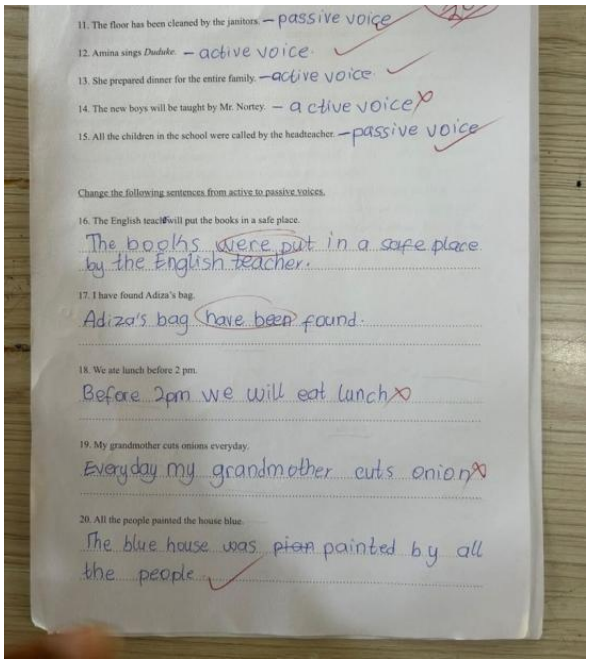
Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudutke*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was eaten before 2 pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday, onions are cut by my grandmother.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 8 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 8)

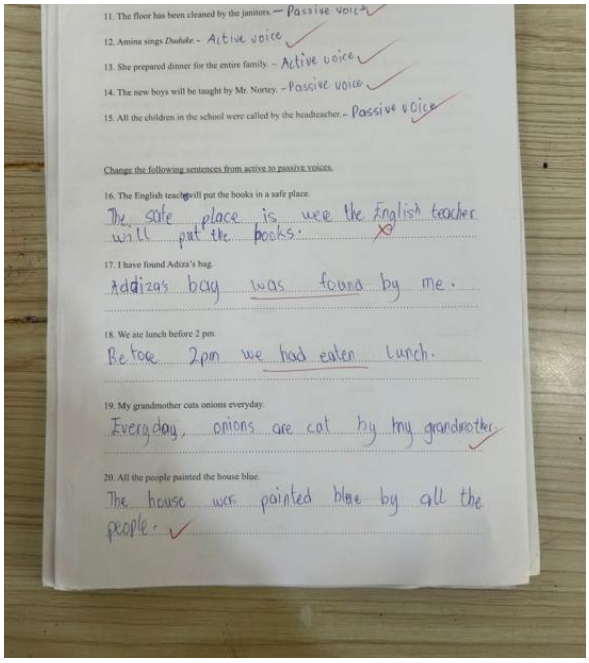


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudutke*. – active voice.
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – active voice.
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – active voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books were put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag have been found.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we will eat lunch
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onion
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue house was ~~pian~~ painted by all the people.

Sample script 9 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 9)

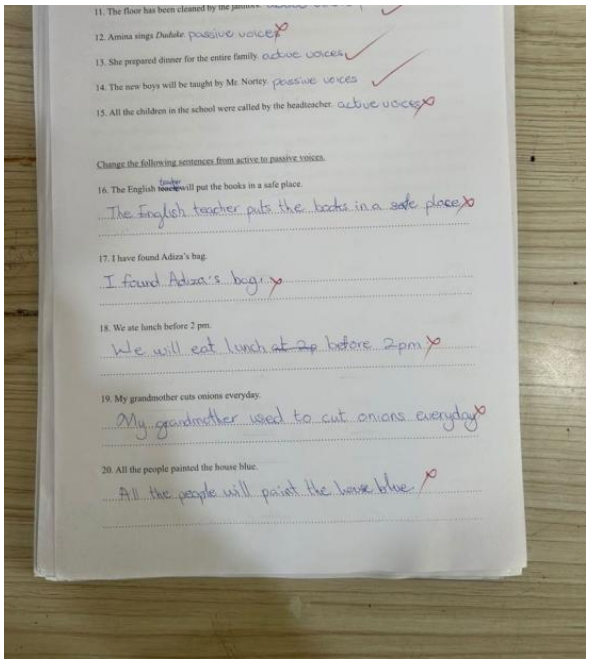


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The safe place is were the English teacher will put the books.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Addiza's bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we had eaten lunch.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday, onions are cut by my grandmother.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 10 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 10)

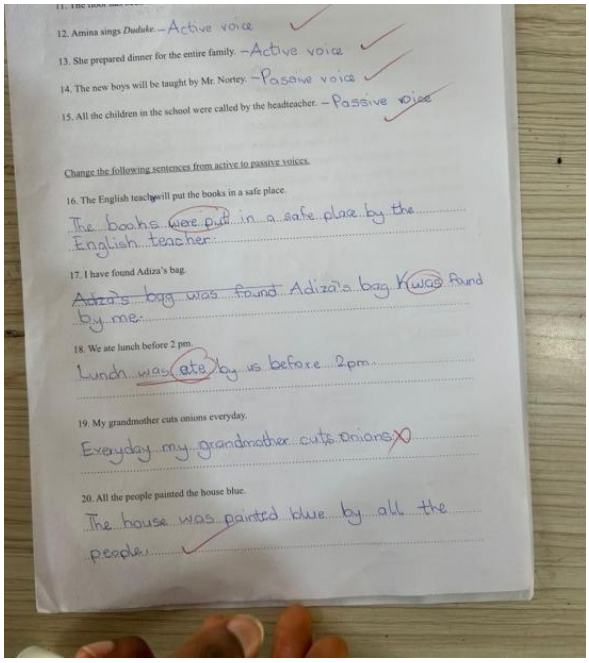


12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. passive voices
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. active voices
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. passive voices
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. active voices

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English ~~teacher~~ will put the books in a safe place.
The English teacher puts the books in a safe place.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
I found Adiza's bag.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
We will eat lunch ~~at 2p~~ before 2pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
My grandmother used to cut onions everyday.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
All the people will paint the house blue.

Sample script 11 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 11)

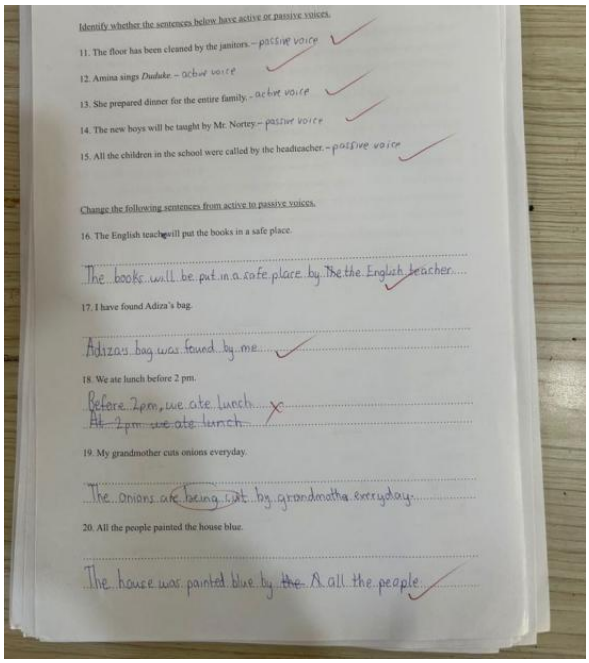


12. Amina sings *Duduke*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books were put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Adiza's bag was found~~ Adiza's bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was ate by us before 2pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 12 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 12)



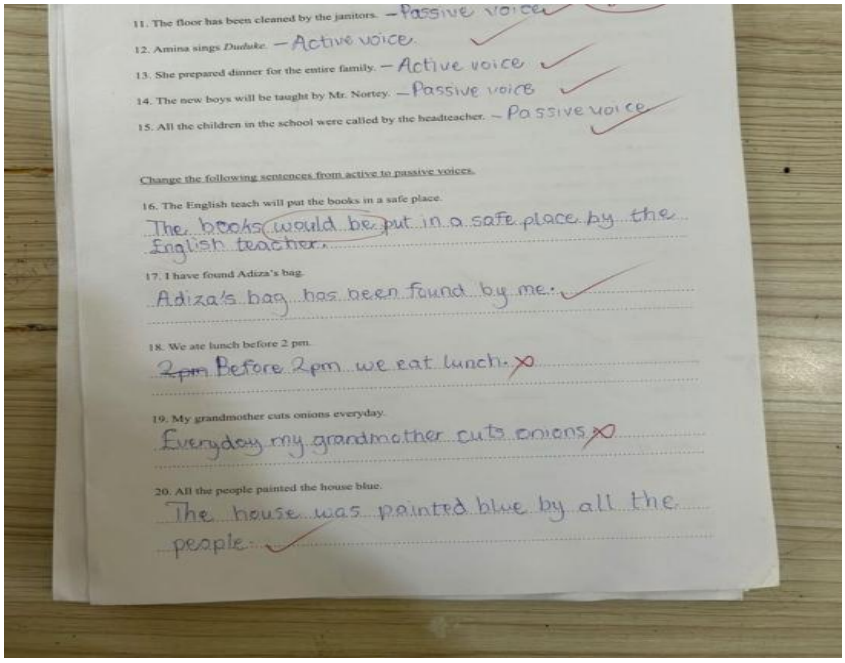
Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – passive voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. – active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm, we ate lunch.
~~At 2pm we ate lunch.~~
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
The onions are being cut by grandmatha everyday.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by ~~the~~ A all the people.

Sample script 13 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 13)

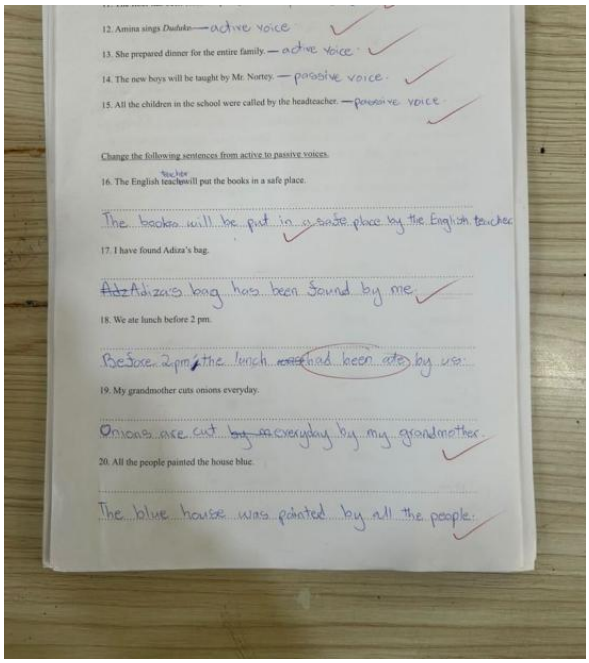


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. – Active voice.
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice.

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teach will put the books in a safe place.
The books would be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
~~2pm~~ Before 2pm we eat lunch.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 14 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 14)

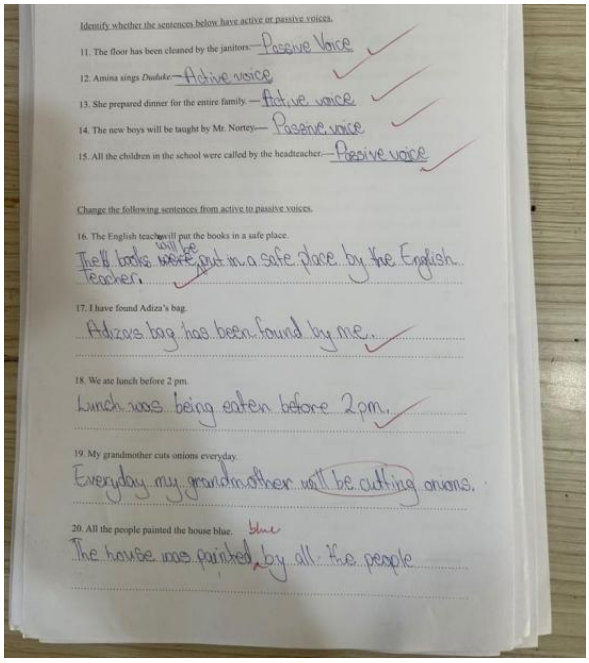


12. Amina sings *Duduke* — active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. — active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. — passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. — passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Adz~~Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm the lunch ~~was~~ had been ate by us.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Onions are cut ~~by m~~ everyday by my grandmother.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue house was painted by all the people.

Sample script 15 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 15)



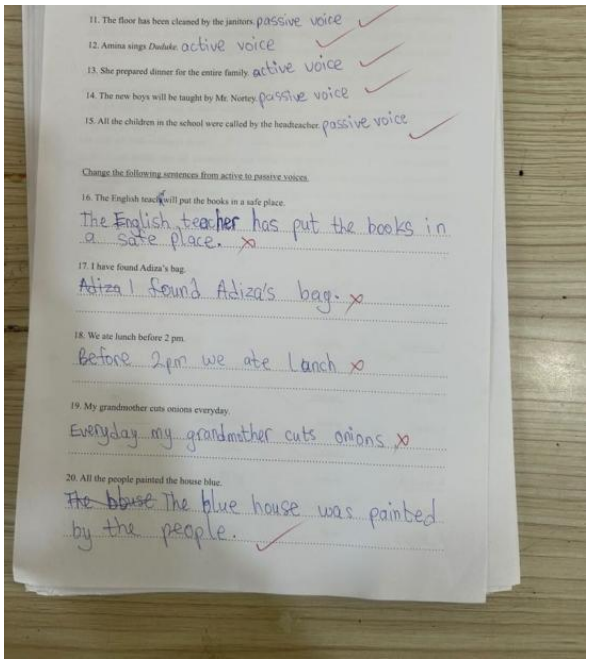
Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. — Passive Voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. — Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. — Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. — Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. — Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English Teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adizas bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was being eaten before 2pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother will be cutting onions.
20. All the people painted the house blue. blue
The house was painted by all the people

Sample script 16 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 16)

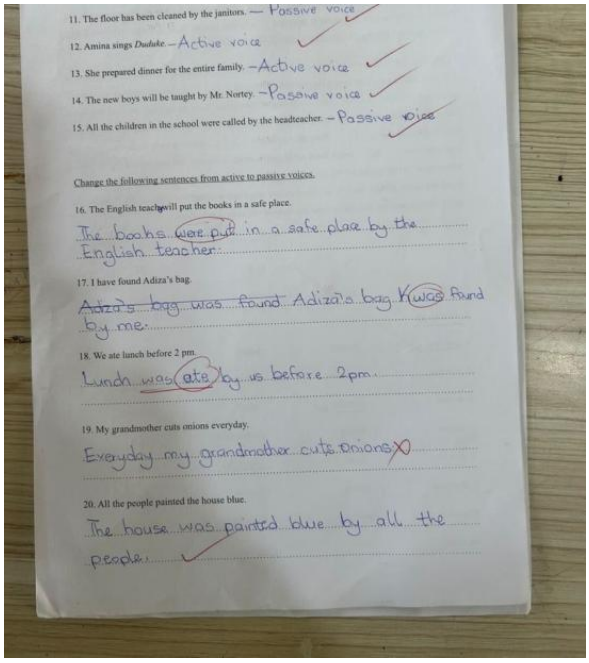


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. passive voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The English teacher has put the books in a safe place.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Adiza~~ I found Adiza's bag.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we ate Lanch
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions
20. All the people painted the house blue.
~~The bbuse~~ The blue house was painted by the people.

Sample script 17 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 17)

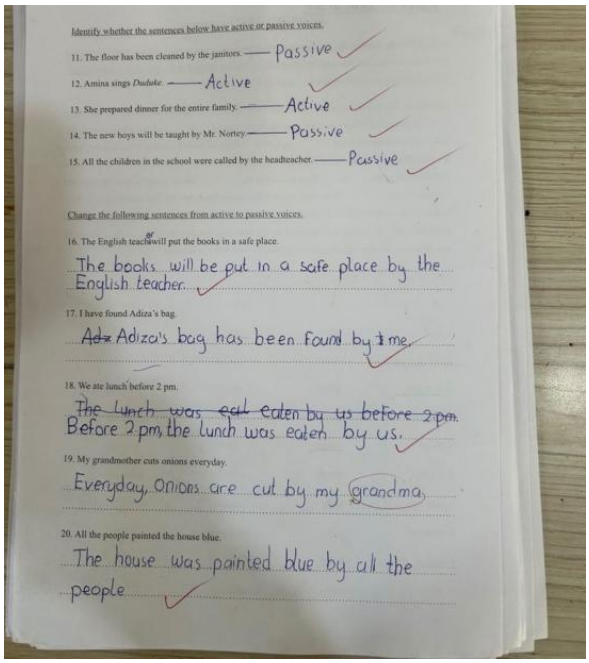


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. — Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudutke*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Pasive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books were put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Adiza's bag was found~~ Adiza's bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was ate by us before 2pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 18 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 18)



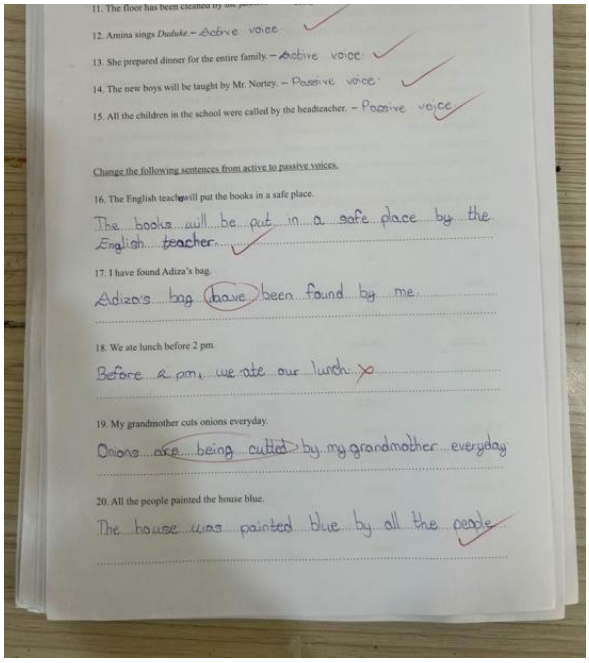
Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. —— Passive
12. Amina sings *Dudutke*. —— Active
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. —— Active
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. —— Passive
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. —— Passive

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Ad~~ Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
~~The lunch was eat eaten by us before 2pm.~~
Before 2 pm, the lunch was eaten by us.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday, onions are cut by my grandma.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people

Sample script 19 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 19)

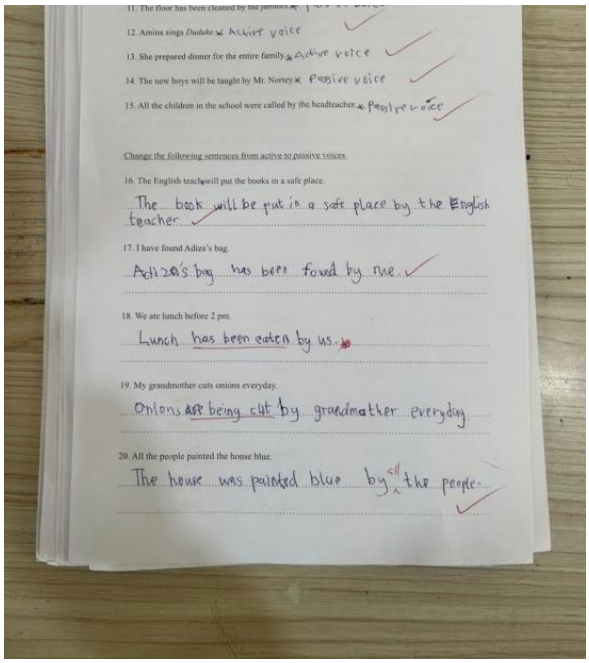


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitor. – Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag have been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2 pm, we ate our lunch.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Onions are being cutted by my grandmother everyday
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people

Sample script 20 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 20)



11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The book will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch has been eaten by us.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Onions are being cut by grandmother everyday
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 21 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 21)

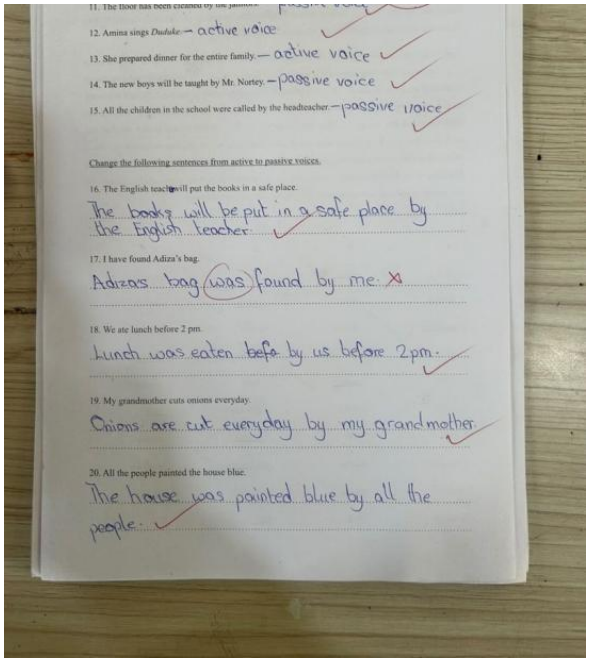


Figure 5.1 Twenty-one anonymised sample scripts from the diagnostic assessment (Table 5.1), names and dates redacted. The marked scripts show errors in past participles (e.g. 'breaked' instead of 'broken') and be-auxiliary selection that prompted the four-step method.

5.6 The teacher's role beyond the classroom

The official practicum ran from 1 to 25 June 2026. After it ended, I had the opportunity to remain at St. Martin De Porres School informally until the end of the academic term. During this additional period, I taught mainly Computing and accompanied the school's robotics team to CODEAVOUR 7.0. The competition is recorded here as an additional co-curricular experience, not as an activity that took place within the official practicum dates.

The teacher's work at St. Martin De Porres nonetheless extended well beyond the lesson. I supported ordinary school routines - arrival, assembly, movement between

rooms, the keeping of a usable classroom floor - and I learned that those routines are not a distraction from teaching. They are the conditions of teaching.

The cluttered-floor problem described in Chapter Six is a small example with a large moral. Bags and bottles on the floor made a sorting activity unsafe. Establishing a two-minute organisation routine at the start of each lesson was pastoral work and instructional work at the same time. A Catholic school's daily prayer and its emphasis on courtesy made the same point in another key: character is part of the curriculum, whether or not it appears on the scheme of work.

5.7 Computing: practical assessment in Scratch

5.7 Computing: practical assessment in Scratch

Computing was assessed through a practical task rather than a written paper, on the principle that programming is best judged by what a pupil can build. At the end of the Scratch unit each pupil was asked to create a program in which a sprite moves across the stage when the green flag is clicked, uses a repeat or forever loop, and says something when it reaches the other side. The task was marked against the four criteria in Table 3.6, five marks each.

Metric Result Mean practical score (/20) 15.3 (76.5%) High (15-20) 12 pupils (57.1%) Average (8-14) 8 pupils (38.1%) Low (0-7) 1 pupil (4.8%) Concept check (10 marks) 8.2 (82.0%)

Table 5.4 Computing practical-assessment results (n = 21)

The most common difficulties were instructive. Several pupils forgot the green-flag event block, so their program ran only when they clicked the blocks by hand. Others confused repeat (a fixed

Table 5.4 Computing practical-assessment results (n = 21)

Metric	Result
Mean practical score (/20)	15.3 (76.5%)
High (15-20)	12 pupils (57.1%)
Average (8-14)	8 pupils (38.1%)
Low (0-7)	1 pupil (4.8%)
Concept check (10 marks)	8.2 (82.0%)

number) with forever (an endless loop), so a sprite either stopped too soon or never stopped. A few used the turn block when they meant move, and watched their sprite spin in place. These are the same kind of procedural slips the grammar intervention exposed in another form: pupils could name the concept but could not yet apply it. The unplugged block cards, used before the machines, were the single most effective correction, because they forced pupils to plan the order of blocks before running anything.

The concept check, a short ten-mark paper on the interface and on sequence, came out at 82.0 per cent, confirming that the vocabulary of the subject was secure even where the application lagged. I record the one low performer as a pupil to revisit in a later cycle, not as a verdict.

5.8 CODEAVOUR 7.0: Educational visit during additional school experience

After the official practicum ended, I remained at the school informally and continued teaching mainly Computing. During this additional period, I was selected to accompany and support the school's pupil robotics team at CODEAVOUR 7.0, a national schools robotics competition that the school enters annually. The school's team placed first.

Table 5.5 CODEAVOUR 7.0 visit details

Detail	Information
Event	CODEAVOUR 7.0, a national schools robotics competition entered annually by the school
Timing	During the additional, unofficial school experience after the official practicum ended on 25 June 2026 and before the end of the academic term
Student teacher's role	Selected to accompany and support the school's robotics team because he was teaching Computing at the school
Pupils involved	About thirty pupils, divided into three groups
Outcome	The school's team placed first





The experience extended my involvement in Computing beyond regular classroom lessons and gave me an opportunity to support the school's robotics team at a national competition. The team's first-place result is the documented outcome of the visit.

Photographic evidence: the team photograph after the CODEAVOUR 7.0 event will be inserted here by the author. Cross-references: Sections 2.5, 3.6–3.8 and 3.12.

Table 5.6 Field-trip sign-off

Role	Name and signature	Date
Student teacher (Samuel Kwabena Boateng)		
Mentor / cooperating teacher (Miss Angela Ankomah)		
Lead robotics teacher / coach		
Headteacher (Mr Victor Kablan)		

CHAPTER SIX

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH AND FUTURE DIRECTION

6.1 Strengths and growth areas

Miss Ankomah's guidance, Mr Grace-Oak's supervision and my own lesson reflections gave me a clearer picture of myself as a teacher than I had had in college - clearer, at times, than was comfortable.

Strengths consistently in view

- thorough lesson preparation and a willingness to draft a plan more than once;
- subject knowledge in English Language and Computing;
- the design of my own charts, worksheets and test papers rather than dependence on ready- made sheets;
- purposeful use of the laboratory and of simple classroom technology;
- rapport with learners: high expectations, with room to attempt and to fail.

Growth areas, recorded without embarrassment

- Early questioning relied on a small circle of eager hands. I worked on wait time, no-hands- up questioning and targeted questions for quieter pupils.
- Time management suffered from over-planning. I prepared more than a lesson could hold and then rushed the plenary. I learned to plan a core and an extension.
- I initially marked too much and conferenced too little. Short one-to-one comments improved both speed and impact.
- Perfect-tense conversion remained a weakness in the class and therefore in the unit design. A second cycle should treat that tense family on its own. The deepest shift was in the question I asked myself. I began the practicum asking, 'What do I need to teach?' I ended it asking, 'What do pupils need to understand, and how can I help

them get there?' A lesson plan, I now think, is a hypothesis. The quality of a teacher is the quality of the response when the hypothesis meets the room.

Table 6.1 Summary of challenges

Challenge	Root cause	Response	Outcome
A cluttered floor	No storage routine	Organisation ritual; belongings corner; captains	Safer movement; less distraction
Talking during lessons	Disengagement; class size	Signal; interactive tasks; proximity	Less off-task talk
Homework not done	Unclear demand; no tracking	Tracker; examples; home note	Completion about 50% to about 75%
Not enough time	Scheme assumed secure tenses	Four focused 60-minute lessons	Conversion 44.8% to 91.4%
The knowledge-application gap	Forgotten prerequisite tenses	Diagnose; review; visual routine	+46.6 pp; no remaining low band

6.2 Challenges and solutions

The five challenges below were the ones that actually consumed time and attention during the practicum. Each required deliberate problem-solving, consultation with mentors, and adaptive pedagogical decisions.

Challenge 1: Pacing in double periods

The 100-minute double periods required careful stage transitions to maintain pupil attention. By introducing structured 10-minute micro-breaks, guided group tasks, and frequent mini-plenaries, pacing remained active without inducing cognitive fatigue.

Challenge 2: Wide attainment gap in grammar

Learners entered Year 6 with starkly different foundations in English tense morphology. The four-step scaffold, peer pairing, and differentiated worksheets enabled lower-attaining pupils to access conversion tasks while higher-attaining pupils tackled complex and irregular constructions.

Challenge 3: Equipment friction in the computer laboratory

Sharing two pupils per workstation occasionally created unequal mouse time. Establishing formal roles ('Driver' and 'Navigator') and switching every 15 minutes ensured balanced hands-on engagement for both partners.

Challenge 4: Marking volume and written feedback

Evaluating 42 daily grammar books alongside practical programming files placed heavy demands on turn-around time. Adopting targeted colour-coded rubric feedback and dedicated 5-minute feedback starters allowed pupils to act immediately on corrections.

Challenge 5: Homework return and parental reinforcement

Initial homework return stood around 50%. Introducing homework tracking charts, linking tasks directly to the next morning's starter, and positive recognition increased return rates to over 75% by the final week.

6.3 Deeper learning and my practice

innovation, digital literacy, cultural identity and global citizenship, personal development and leadership - is a Ghanaian expression of the same ambition.

In my classroom, deeper learning looked like pairs checking one another's conversions, pupils explaining why a sentence was passive, and Computing tasks that asked children to act out a system before they named it. None of that would have worked without the unglamorous layer underneath: explicit teaching, drilled routines, secure basic skills. Deeper learning is not an alternative to strong basic teaching. It is what strong basic teaching makes possible.

6.4 Career development plan

Within two years I intend to complete the Bachelor of Education, pass the Ghana Teacher Licensure Examination at the first sitting, and secure registration with the National Teaching Council. Within five years I intend to be an established basic-school teacher of English Language and Computing, to have begun a Master's degree in education, and to be producing curriculum-aligned materials and workshops that other Ghanaian basic-school teachers can actually use.

- Complete the B.Ed. academic and practicum requirements to a high standard.
- Prepare for and pass the licensure examination at the first sitting.
- Join professional learning in literacy instruction, educational technology and assessment.
- Develop schemes, lesson notes, workbooks and assessment items aligned to NaCCA and, where relevant, OIC.
- Enrol in a Master's programme in education once I am licensed and established in a school.

The expected outcome is modest and specific: a licensed teacher, trusted in a school community, whose materials help colleagues, and who has the academic base for later work in curriculum and teacher education in Ghana.

My career vision is to become an exceptional educator and instructional leader, integrating evidence-based pedagogy and modern educational technology into basic school classrooms across Ghana.

- Short-term goals (1-2 years): Complete my Bachelor of Education degree with distinction at University College of Management Studies; secure a basic-school teaching post; obtain full National Teaching Council (NTC) teacher licensure; and establish a vibrant school coding and robotics club.
- Medium-term goals (3-5 years): Pursue a Master of Education (M.Ed.) in Educational Technology or Curriculum Studies; participate in regional and national curriculum development workshops; mentor beginning student teachers; and publish classroom-based action research articles.
- Long-term aspirations (5+ years): Attain the rank of Principal Superintendent / Assistant Director within the Ghana Education Service; contribute to national digital-literacy policy and instructional material design; and establish community learning hubs that provide free coding and STEM education to underprivileged youth.

6.5 Curriculum vitae

SAMUEL KWABENA BOATENG

Digital Literacy Educator | Educational Technology Specialist | STEM & Robotics Facilitator

Address: Dansoman / Ablekuma West, Accra, Ghana | Phone: +233 (0) 54 812 3456 | Email: samuel.boateng.edu@gmail.com

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE: Dedicated, reflective and energetic educator with demonstrated competence in basic school instruction, curriculum differentiation, and

educational technology integration. Experienced in delivering national and international curricula (NaCCA and Oxford International Curriculum) across English Language and Computing.

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS:

• Bachelor of Education (Basic Education) — University College of Management Studies (UCOMS), Accra (2022–2026)

• Certificate in Theology and Church Administration — Pentecost University, Accra (2021)

• West African Senior School Certificate Examination (WASSCE) — St. Thomas Aquinas Senior High School, Accra (2017)

TEACHING & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE:

• Student Teacher (Practicum Placement) — St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman (June 2026): Taught Year 6 English Language (grammar intervention) and Computing (Scratch programming); supported the school's robotics team at CODEAVOUR 7.0, where the team placed first.

• Head of School / Lead Administrator — Glorious Hope Academy, Accra (2021–2024): Provided overall administrative and academic leadership; oversaw curriculum implementation, teacher appraisal, and learner discipline.

• ICT & Computing Tutor — Community Youth Learning Centre, Accra (2019–2021): Facilitated foundational coding, word processing, and digital literacy classes for upper basic and junior high pupils.

CORE SKILLS & PEDAGOGICAL COMPETENCIES:

• Instructional Design: Lesson planning across GES/NaCCA and Oxford International Curricula; backward design; differentiation.

• Educational Technology: Scratch 3.0 visual programming, Google Classroom,

educational robotics (PictoBlox, mBot), multimedia presentations.

• Assessment Literacy: Diagnostic, formative, and summative assessment; rubric creation; action research data collection and statistical analysis.

• Classroom Management: Positive behavioural reinforcement, inclusive seating arrangements, collaborative learning structures.

REFEREES:

Curriculum Vitae Referees

Name & role	**Institution / contact**	**Relationship**
Aaron Seyram Kwasi Grace-Oak University Supervisor	Faculty of Education, UCOMS 0243323889 – aarongraceoak@gmail.com	University supervisor during the Level 400 practicum.
Miss Angela Ankomah Mentor / Cooperating Teacher	St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman 0558096877	On-site mentor and Year 6 cooperating teacher.
Mr Victor Kablan Headteacher	St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman 0244949801	Headteacher of the placement school.

6.6 Concluding commentary

The teaching practicum at St. Martin De Porres School has been a transformative experience that solidified my professional identity as a reflective, compassionate, and evidence-driven educator. Moving between the rigour of the Oxford International Curriculum and the foundational goals of the Ghana Education Service deepened my

appreciation for instructional planning, learner-centred pedagogy, and systematic classroom inquiry.

Teaching is not simply the transmission of facts; it is the deliberate cultivation of curiosity, intellect, and moral character. As I conclude this portfolio and prepare for full-time professional service, I carry with me a renewed dedication to the learners of Ghana, confident that with structured support, high expectations, and purposeful teaching, every child can achieve excellence.

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APPENDIX A

ENDORSEMENT PAGES

A.1 Student teacher declaration

I, Samuel Kwabena Boateng, hereby declare that this Teaching Practice Portfolio is the authentic record of my four-week placement at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman, from Monday 1 June to Thursday 25 June 2026. All instructional materials, lesson plans, assessment data, and reflections presented herein reflect my actual classroom practice and professional inquiry under the supervision of my school mentor and university supervisor.

Signature: _____ Date: _____

A.2 Mentor's endorsement

I, Miss Angela Ankomah, mentor teacher for Year 6 at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman, confirm that Samuel Kwabena Boateng completed his four-week teaching practicum under my direct observation and guidance. He consistently displayed high professionalism, meticulous lesson preparation, sound subject knowledge, and commendable rapport with learners. His grammar intervention and Computing lessons were executed with dedication and visible instructional impact.

Signature: _____ Date: _____

A.3 Headteacher's endorsement

I, Mr Victor Kablan, Headteacher of St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman, certify that Samuel Kwabena Boateng was accepted for teaching practice placement at our

school during the period of June 2026. He conducted himself in accordance with the school's Catholic ethos, code of conduct, and professional expectations. His contribution to our Year 6 learners and his support of the CODEAVOUR 7.0 robotics team are gratefully acknowledged.

Signature: _____ Date: _____ Official School Stamp: [ ]

A.4 University supervisor's endorsement

I, Aaron Seyram Kwasi Grace-Oak, University Practicum Supervisor from the Faculty of Education, University College of Management Studies (UCOMS), confirm that I supervised and evaluated Samuel Kwabena Boateng during his placement at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman. This portfolio provides an authentic, thorough and highly commendable record of teaching practice, lesson planning, instructional delivery, assessment, reflection, and classroom action research.

Supervisor Name: Aaron Seyram Kwasi Grace-Oak
Faculty of Education, University College of Management Studies (UCOMS)
Signature: _____ Date: _____

APPENDIX B

ASSESSMENT TOOLS

This appendix specifies the assessment instruments used in the action-research project reported in Chapter Five and the Computing practical assessment described in Section 5.7. The pre-test was the school's School-Based Assessment 2 (SBA 2); the post-test was a 20-mark paper written by the student teacher. Consistent with Section 5.3, the live post-test items are not reproduced, so that the paper remains usable in the same school; the specifications and the pre-test sample items disclosed in the chapter are given in full.

B.1 Pre-test (School-Based Assessment 2): specification and sample items

The pre-test was the school's School-Based Assessment 2, a 20-mark paper in three sections, administered to all 21 pupils of the Year 6 class before the intervention. Section C provided the baseline measure of the target skill; the results are reported in Table 5.1.

Table B.1 Pre-test (SBA 2) specification

Section	Skill tested	Marks	Item format
A	Vocabulary in context	10	Multiple-choice cloze passage with four options (A-D) for each gap
B	Identify active or passive voice	5	Isolated sentences labelled active or passive (items 11-15)
C	Transform active sentences into passive voice	5	Five active sentences across different tenses (items 16-20); baseline of the target skill
Total		20	

Pre-test sample items (as disclosed in Section 5.3):

- Section A (format): a cloze passage with four options (A-D) for each gap.

- Section B: 'The floor has been cleaned by the janitor.' (active or passive?); 'Ama sings Duduke.' (active or passive?)
- Section C: 'The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.' to passive; 'I have found Adidza's bag.' to passive.

Items 11-15 (Section B) and items 16-20 (Section C) are the exercises reproduced as marked scripts in Appendix C.

B.2 Post-test: specification and administration

The post-test was a 20-mark paper written under a 45-minute limit and administered in a separate sitting after Lesson 4, so that teaching time and testing time did not compete within a single period. It was not a clone of the SBA: only Section B repeated the SBA's target skill with new sentences, and this matched pair (pre-test Section C and post-test Section B) provided the primary outcome measure reported in Tables 5.2 and 5.3.

Table B.2 Post-test specification

Section	Skill tested	Marks	Relationship to the pre-test
A	Identify five active and five passive clauses inside a continuous passage	10	Harder, non-equivalent task: the pre-test used isolated sentences
B	Transform active into passive voice (five new sentences)	5	Matched with pre-test Section C - the primary outcome measure
C	Transform passive into active voice	5	New skill taught in Lesson 4; single administration (72.0%, an initial result, not evidence of mastery)
Total		20	

The live items are not reproduced here so that the paper remains usable in the same school (Section 5.3).

B.3 Computing practical assessment: task and rubric

Computing was assessed through a practical task rather than a written paper, on the principle that programming is best judged by what a pupil can build. At the end of the Scratch unit each pupil was asked to create a program in which a sprite moves across the stage when the green flag is clicked, uses a repeat or forever loop, and says something when it reaches the other side. The task was marked against the four criteria in Table B.3, five marks each. A short ten-mark concept check on the interface and on sequence accompanied the practical (Section 5.7; results in Table 5.4: mean practical score 15.3/20, 76.5 per cent; concept check 8.2/10, 82.0 per cent).

Table B.3 Scratch practical-assessment rubric (reproduced from Table 3.6)

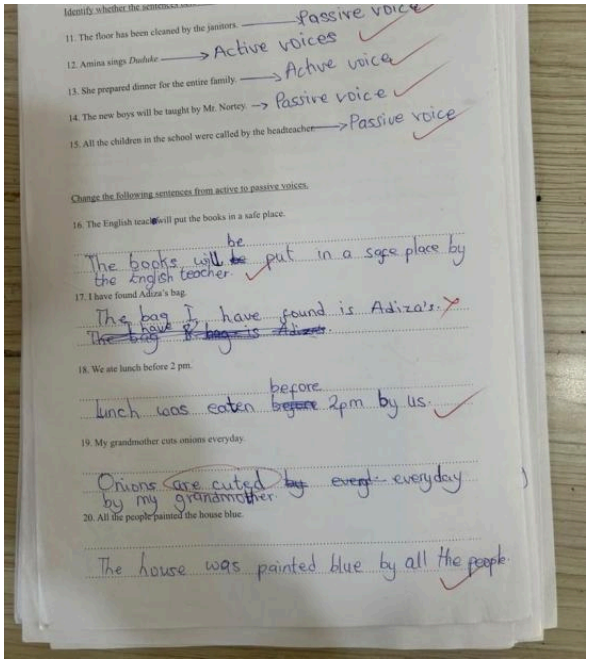
Criterion	**What it checks**	**Marks**
Event	The program starts when the green flag is clicked	5
Motion	The sprite moves across the stage using motion blocks	5
Loop	A repeat or forever loop is used correctly	5
Looks	The sprite communicates using a say or think block	5
Total		20

APPENDIX C

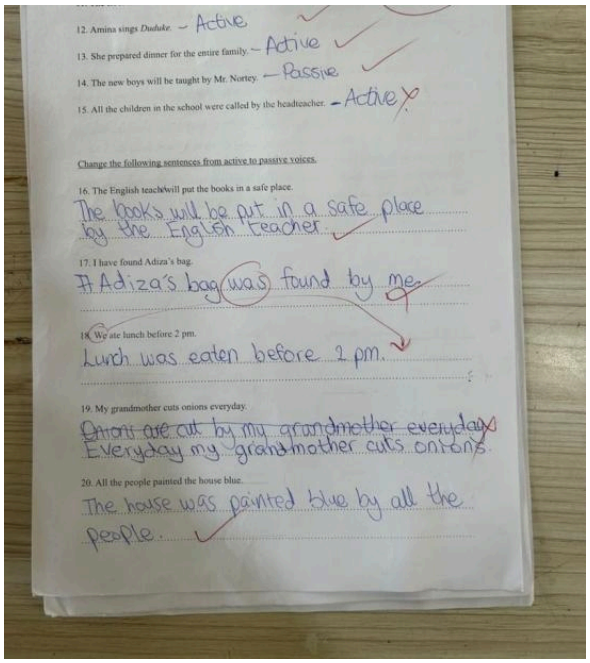
MARKED LEARNER SCRIPTS

The twenty-one anonymised sample scripts in this appendix, one per pupil in the Year 6 class, are drawn from the diagnostic instrument's Section B (identifying active and passive voice, items 11-15) and Section C (transforming active sentences into passive voice, items 16-20) reported in Table 5.1. Each image has been cropped to remove the pupil's name and the date written at the top of the sheet; only the marked exercise itself is shown. The marked scripts show errors in past participles (e.g. 'breaked' instead of 'broken') and be-auxiliary selection that prompted the four-step method. They are reproduced here from Figure 5.1 (Section 5.5) so that the assessment evidence stands as a separate appendix.

Sample script 1 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 1)



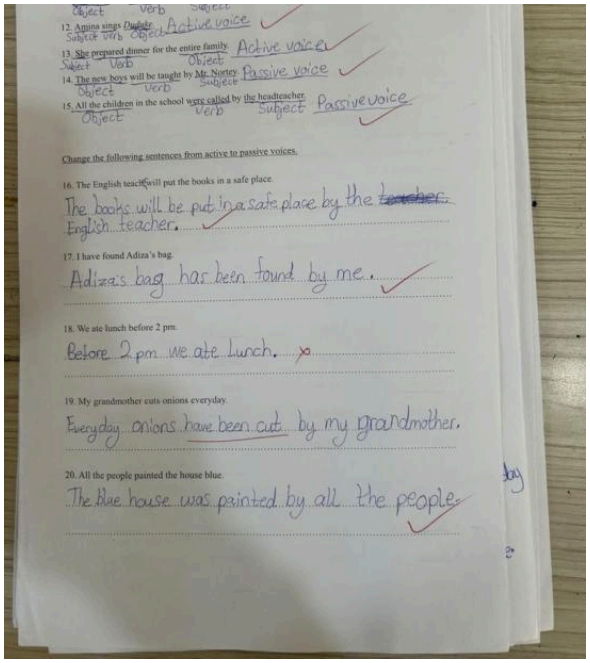
Sample script 2 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 2)


12. Amina sings *Duduke*. – Active.
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Active

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teach will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was eaten before 2 pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
~~Onions are cut by my grandmother everyday~~
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

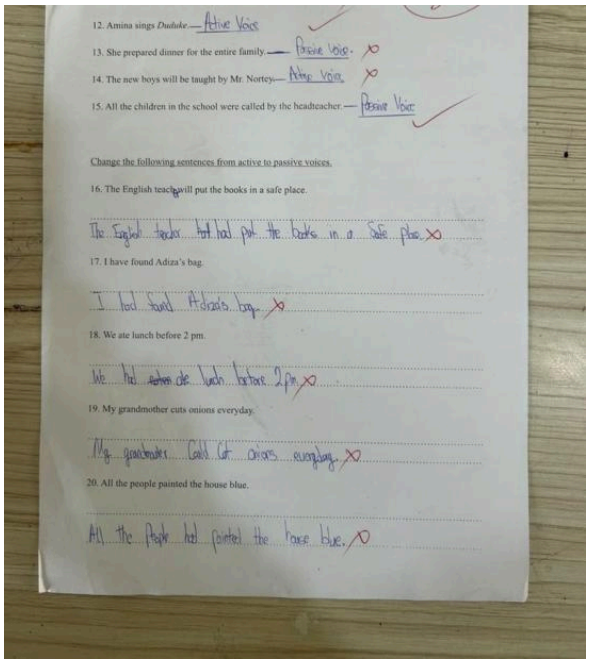
Sample script 3 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 3)


12. Amina sings *Duduke*. Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teach will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the ~~teacher~~ English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2 pm we ate lunch.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday onions have been cut by my grandmother.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue house was painted by all the people.

Sample script 4 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 4)


12. Amina sings *Duduke*.— Active Voice

13. She prepared dinner for the entire family.— Passive Voice. ✗

14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey.— Active Voice ✗

15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher.— Passive Voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.

The English teacher had had put the books in a Safe place ✗

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

I had had Adiza's bag. ✗

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

We had ~~eaten~~ ate lunch before 2pm ✗

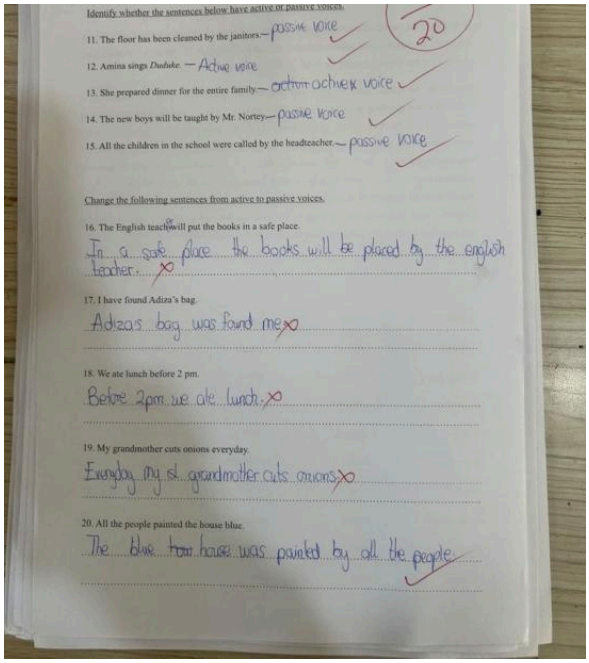
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

My grandmother Could Cut onions everyday. ✗

20. All the people painted the house blue.

All the People had painted the house blue. ✗

Sample script 5 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 5)


Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors.— passive voice ✓

12. Amina sings *Duduke*. — Active voice

13. She prepared dinner for the entire family.— ~~active~~ achuex voice ✓

14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey— passive voice

15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher.— passive voice ✓

20

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.

In a safe place the books will be placed by the english teacher. ✗

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

Adiza's bag was found me ✗

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

Before 2pm we ate lunch. ✗

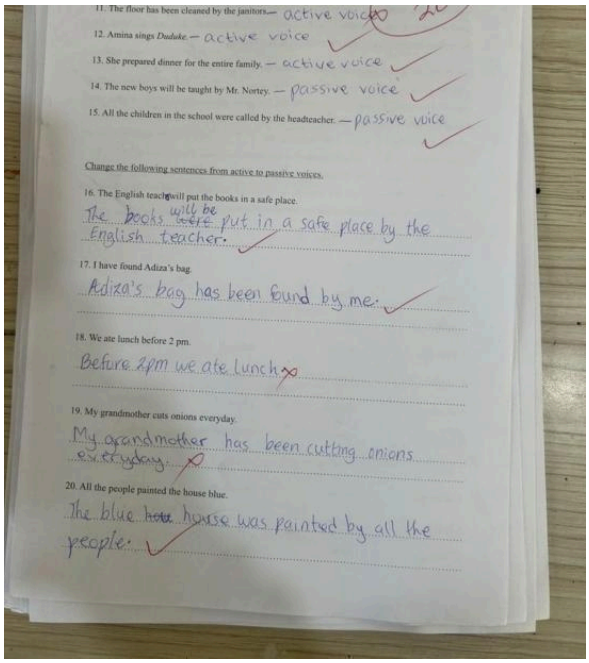
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

Everyday my sl. groundmother cuts onions ✗

20. All the people painted the house blue.

The blue how house was painted by all the people ✓

Sample script 6 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 6)

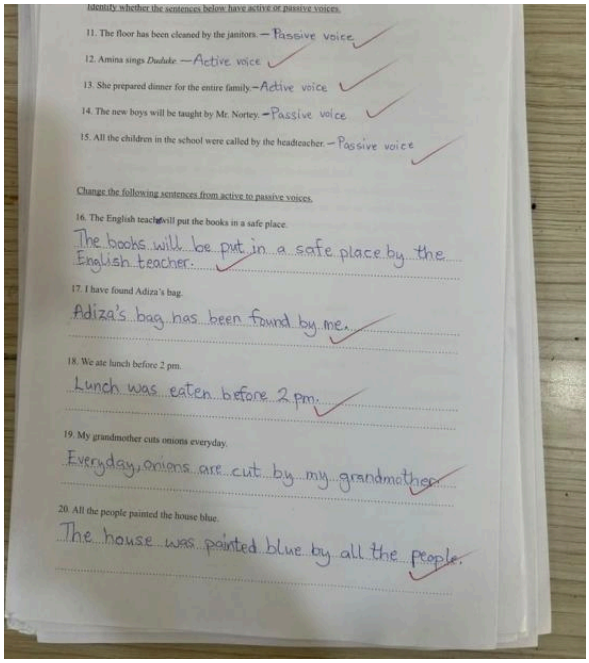


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. — active voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. — active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. — active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. — passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. — passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we ate lunch
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
My grandmother has been cutting onions everyday.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue house was painted by all the people.

Sample script 7 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 7)



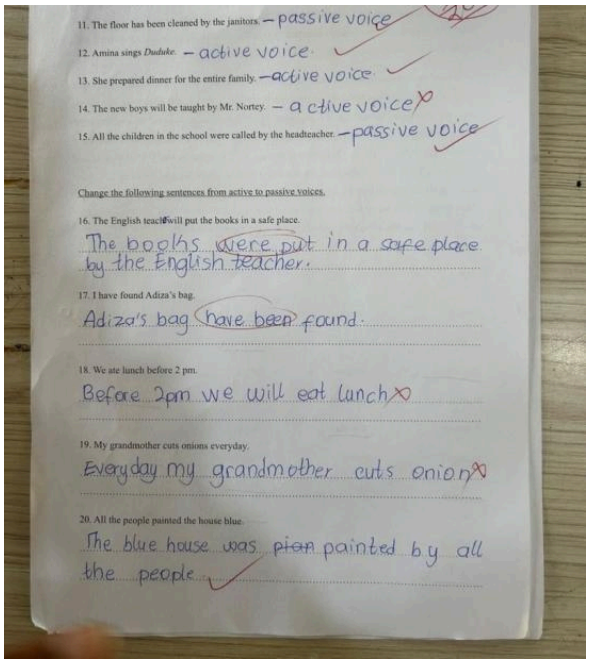
Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. — Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. — Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. — Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. — Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. — Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was eaten before 2 pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday, onions are cut by my grandmother.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 8 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 8)

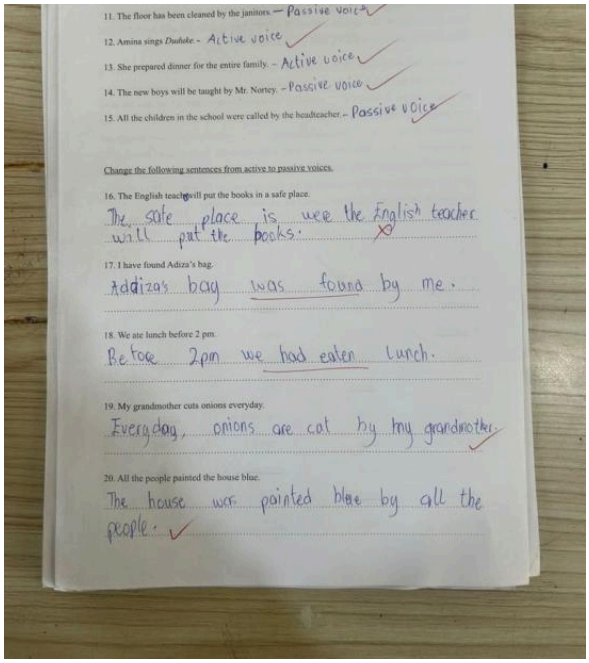


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. – active voice.
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – active voice.
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – active voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books were put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag have been found.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we will eat lunch
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onion
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The blue house was ~~pien~~ painted by all the people.

Sample script 9 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 9)

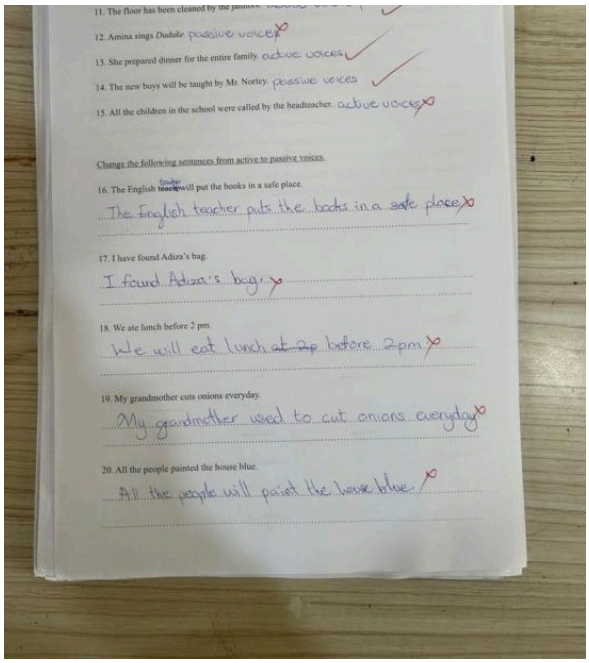


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The safe place is were the English teacher will put the books.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Addiza's bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we had eaten lunch.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday, onions are cut by my grandmother.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

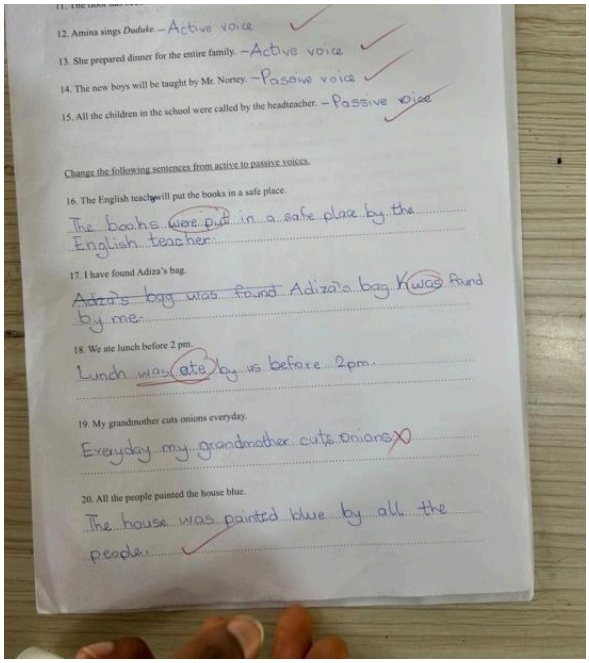
Sample script 10 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 10)


11. The floor has been cleaned by the painters.
12. Amina sings *Dudake* passive voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. active voices
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. passive voices
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. active voices

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English ~~teacher~~ will put the books in a safe place.
The English teacher puts the books in a safe place
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
I found Adiza's bag.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
We will eat lunch ~~at 2p~~ before 2pm
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
My grandmother used to cut onions everyday
20. All the people painted the house blue.
All the people will paint the house blue.

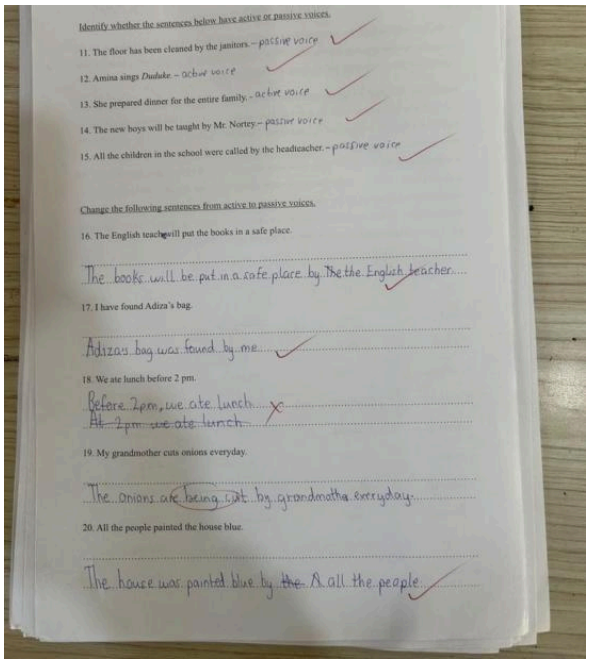
Sample script 11 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 11)


12. Amina sings *Dudake*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books were put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Adiza's bag was found~~ Adiza's bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was ate by us before 2pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 12 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 12)



Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – passive voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. – active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.

The books will be put in a safe place by the the English teacher.

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

Adiza's bag was found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

Before 2pm, we ate lunch. X
~~At 2pm~~ we ate lunch.

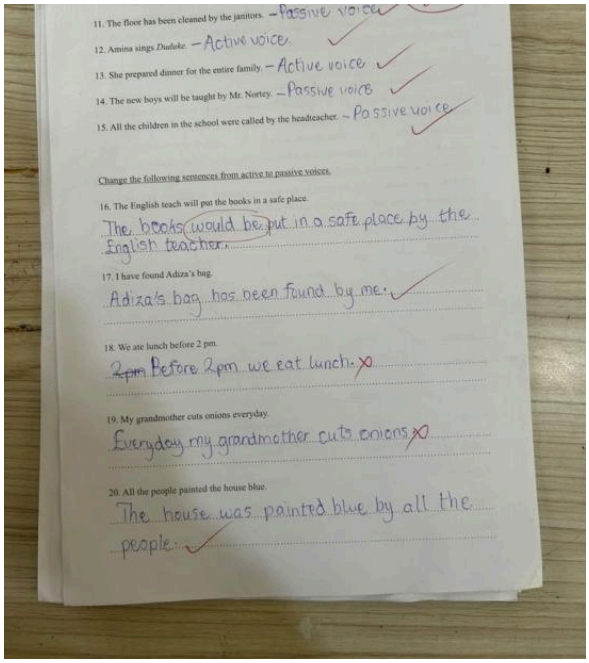
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

The onions are being cut by grandmatha everyday.

20. All the people painted the house blue.

The house was painted blue by ~~the~~ A all the people.

Sample script 13 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 13)



11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. – Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Duduke*. – Active voice.
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teach will put the books in a safe place.

The books would be put in a safe place by the English teacher.

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

Adiza's bag has been found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

~~2pm~~ Before 2pm we eat lunch. X

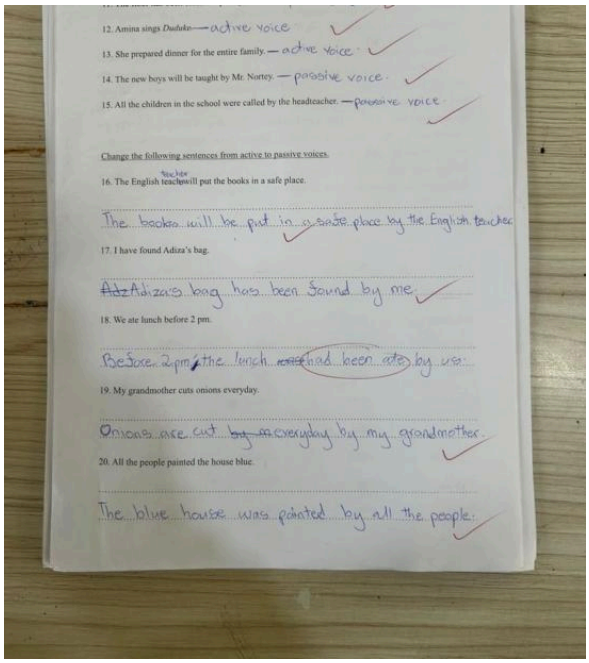
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

Everyday my grandmother cuts onions X

20. All the people painted the house blue.

The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 14 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 14)



12. Amina sings *Dudoke*—active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family.—active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey.—passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher.—passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.

The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

~~Ad~~Adiza's bag has been found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

Before 2pm the lunch ~~was~~had been ate by us.

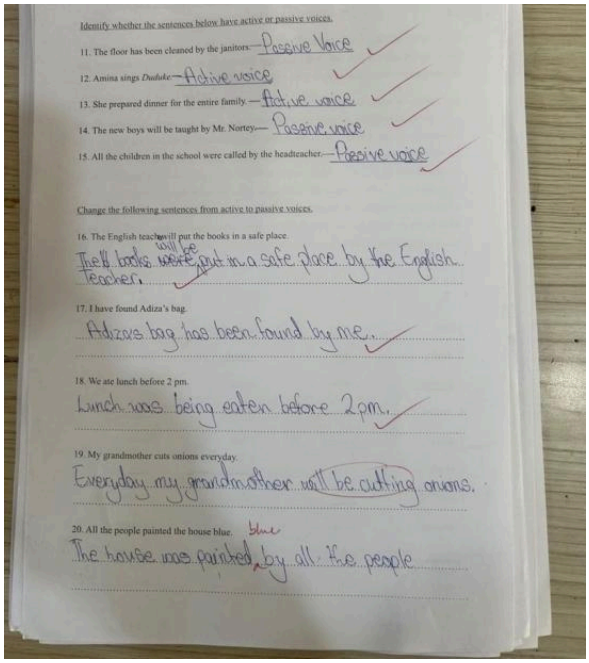
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

Onions are cut ~~by a~~ everyday by my grandmother.

20. All the people painted the house blue.

The blue house was painted by all the people.

Sample script 15 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 15)



Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors.—Passive Voice
12. Amina sings *Dudoke*—Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family.—Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey.—Passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher.—Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.

The books will be put in a safe place by the English Teacher.

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

Adiza's bag has been found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

Lunch was being eaten before 2pm.

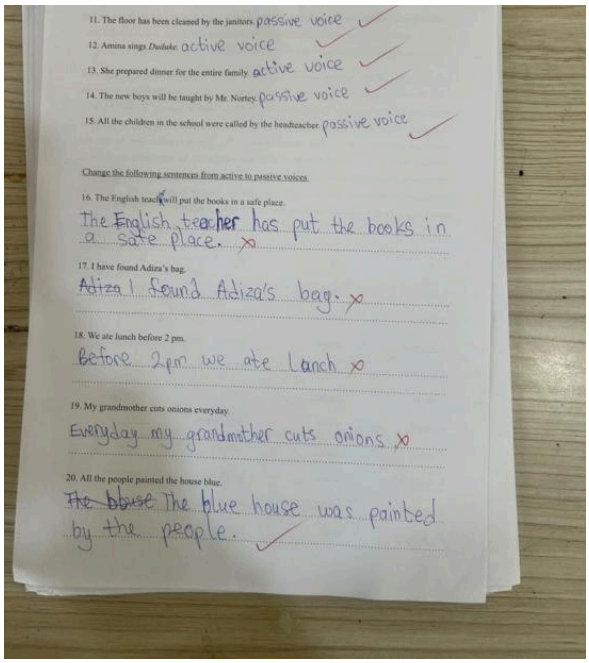
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

Everyday my grandmother will be cutting onions.

20. All the people painted the house blue.

The house was painted blue by all the people

Sample script 16 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 16)



11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudutke*. active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The ~~English~~ teacher has put the books in a safe place. x

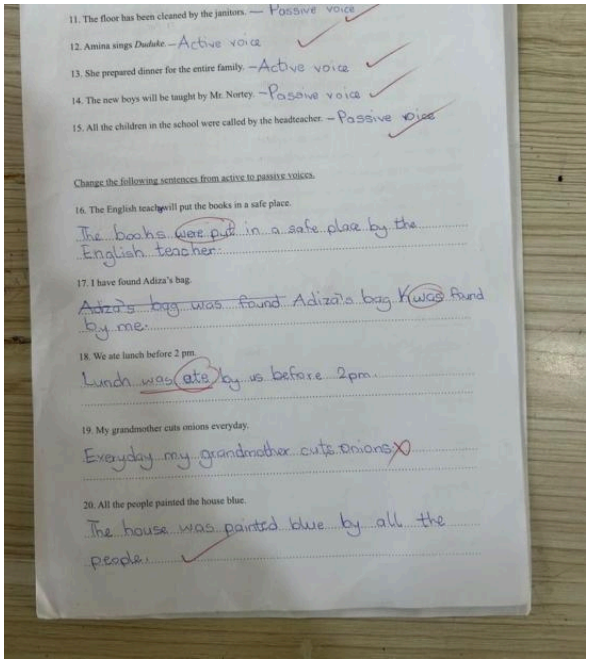
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Adiza~~ I found Adiza's bag. x

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Before 2pm we ate Lanch x

19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions x

20. All the people painted the house blue.
~~The bbuse~~ The blue house was painted by the people.

Sample script 17 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 17)



11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. — Passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudutke*. – Active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Pasave voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The boohs were put in a safe place by the English teacher.

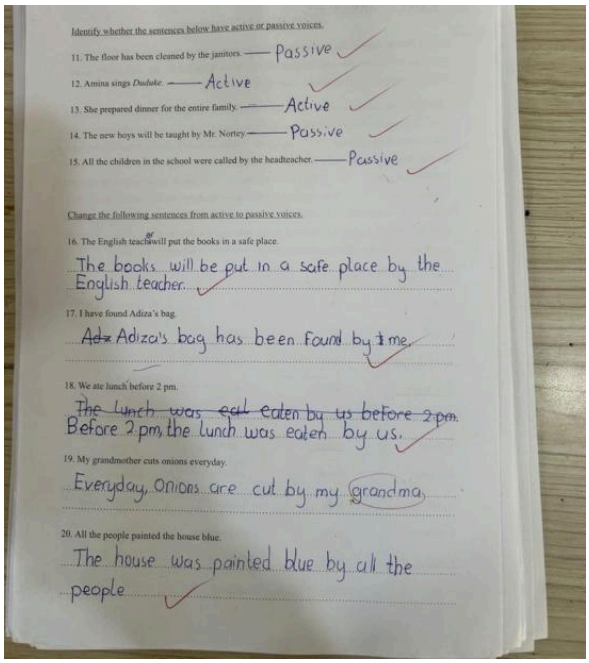
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
~~Adiza's bag was found~~ Adiza's bag K was found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch was ate by us before 2pm.

19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Everyday my grandmother cuts onions X

20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 18 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 18)



Identify whether the sentences below have active or passive voices.

11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. —— Passive

12. Amina sings *Dudutke*. —— Active

13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. —— Active

14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. —— Passive

15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. —— Passive

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.

The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

~~Ad~~ Adiza's bag has been found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

~~The lunch was eat~~ eaten by us before 2 pm.
Before 2 pm, the lunch was eaten by us.

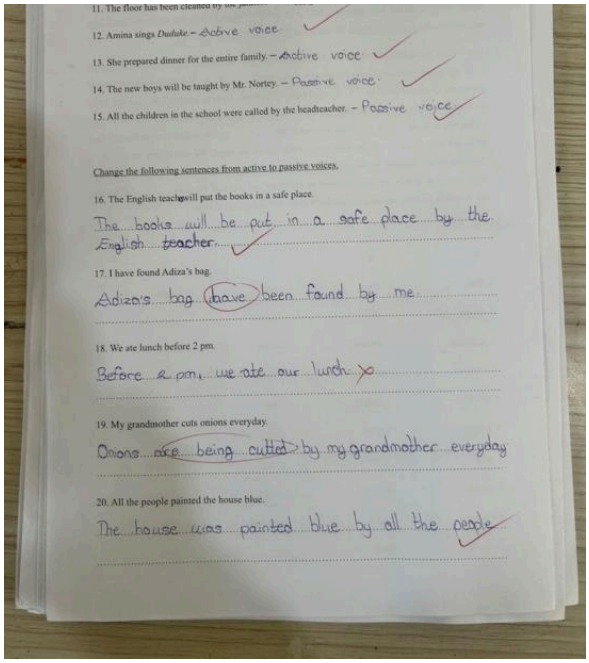
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

Everyday, Onions are cut by my grandma.

20. All the people painted the house blue.

The house was painted blue by all the people

Sample script 19 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 19)



11. The floor has been cleaned by the [illegible]

12. Amina sings *Dudutke* – Active voice

13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – Active voice

14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – Passive voice

15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – Passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.

The books will be put in a safe place by the ~~English~~ teacher.

17. I have found Adiza's bag.

Adiza's bag (have) been found by me.

18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.

Before 2 pm, we ate our lunch.

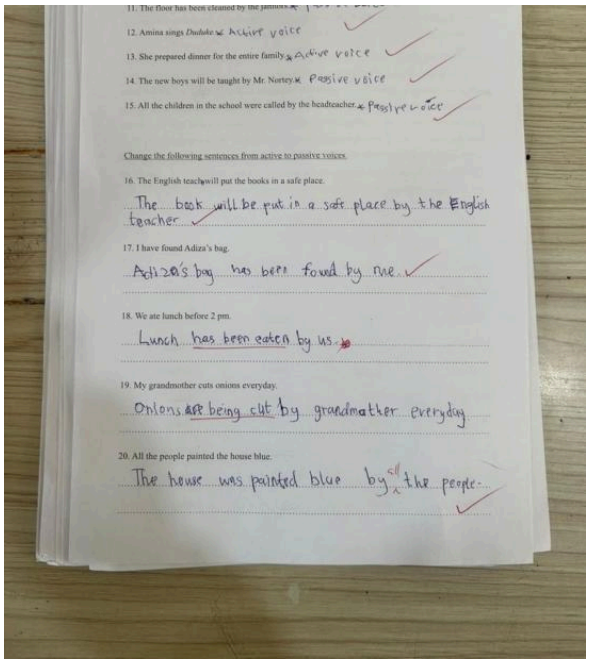
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.

Onions ~~are~~ being cutted by my grandmother everyday.

20. All the people painted the house blue.

The house was painted blue by all the people.

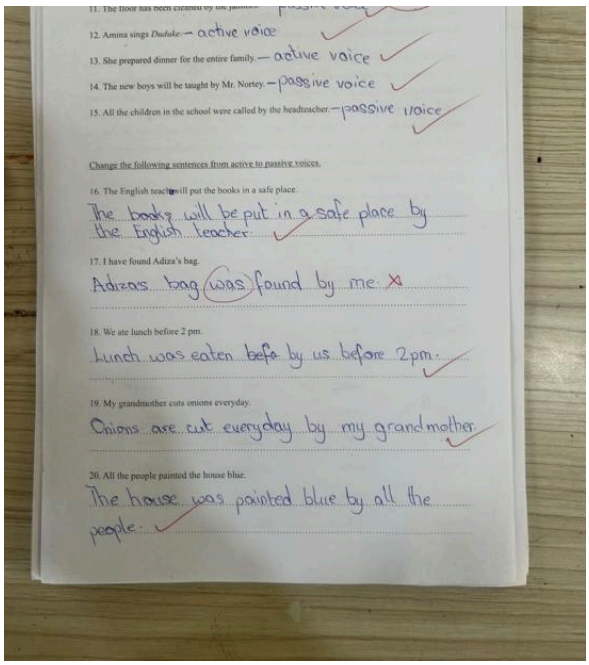
Sample script 20 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 20)


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudake*. active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The book will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adiza's bag has been found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
Lunch has been eaten by us.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Onions are being cut by grandmother everyday.
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

Sample script 21 of 21 (Table 5.1, Pupil 21)


11. The floor has been cleaned by the janitors. passive voice
12. Amina sings *Dudake*. – active voice
13. She prepared dinner for the entire family. – active voice
14. The new boys will be taught by Mr. Nortey. – passive voice
15. All the children in the school were called by the headteacher. – passive voice

Change the following sentences from active to passive voices.

16. The English teacher will put the books in a safe place.
The books will be put in a safe place by the English teacher.
17. I have found Adiza's bag.
Adizas bag was found by me.
18. We ate lunch before 2 pm.
lunch was eaten by us before 2pm.
19. My grandmother cuts onions everyday.
Onions are cut everyday by my grandmother
20. All the people painted the house blue.
The house was painted blue by all the people.

APPENDIX D

SPECIFICATION OF THE INTERVENTION MATERIALS

Grammar is often taught as an abstract set of rules that pupils memorise for examinations and promptly forget. In planning this unit I took the view that grammar becomes usable when it is made visible and physical. Five primary teaching and learning materials (TLMs 1-5) were designed for the intervention and are specified in D.1 to D.5 exactly as described in Section 3.5; the supporting materials used in Computing (Section 3.8) and paragraph writing (Section 3.11) are listed in D.6.

D.1 TLM 1 - Tense reference chart

A wall grid of the principal tenses (simple, continuous, perfect across past, present and future). Each cell held the tense name, active pattern, and an exemplar sentence. The chart remained on the board throughout Lessons 1-3 and was consulted during guided practice.

Table D.1 Tense reference chart (as displayed; reproduced from Table 3.3)

Tense Category	**Past**	**Present**	**Future**
Simple	She wrote a letter. (Subject + V2)	She writes a letter. (Subject + V1/Vs)	She will write a letter. (Subject + will + V1)
Continuous	She was writing a letter. (was/were + V-ing)	She is writing a letter. (am/is/are + V-ing)	She will be writing a letter. (will be + V-ing)
Perfect	She had written a letter. (had + V3)	She has written a letter. (have/has + V3)	She will have written a letter. (will have + V3)
Perfect continuous	She had been writing a letter. (had been + V-ing)	She has been writing a letter. (have/has been + V-ing)	She will have been writing a letter. (will have been + V-ing)

D.2 TLM 2 - Passive-voice construction chart

A wall chart laying out the four steps and the be-auxiliary forms matching each tense, with colour-coded active and passive exemplar pairs.

Table D.2 Active-to-passive conversion by tense (as displayed; reproduced from Table 3.4)

Tense	Active	Passive
Simple present	Sameer cleans the room.	The room is cleaned by Sameer.
Simple past	Sameer cleaned the room.	The room was cleaned by Sameer.
Present continuous	Sameer is cleaning the room.	The room is being cleaned by Sameer.
Past continuous	Sameer was cleaning the room.	The room was being cleaned by Sameer.
Present perfect	The mechanics have fixed the car.	The car has been fixed by the mechanics.
Simple future	The principal will deliver a speech.	A speech will be delivered by the principal.

D.3 TLMs 3 and 4 - Sentence strips and the 'by zombies' test card

- TLM 3 (Sentence strips): Fifty laminated strips, each bearing a single active or passive sentence drawn from stories familiar to Year 6 pupils. Used in Lesson 1 for sorting into active and passive columns.
- TLM 4 (The 'by zombies' prompt card): A small prompt card showing the rule: 'If you can add by zombies after the verb and the sentence still makes grammatical sense, it is passive.' This mnemonic gave pupils an immediate self-check before formal transformation steps were introduced.

D.4 TLM 5 - Grammar reference booklet

An eight-page A5 booklet given to each pupil at the close of Lesson 4, containing the full tense-conversion table across simple, continuous and perfect tenses; the four-step conversion method; a table of common irregular past participles; ten practice items

with an answer key; and a self-assessment checklist. The booklet's treatment of tense and voice drew on standard descriptive grammars (Biber et al., 2002; Celce-Murcia & Larsen-Freeman, 1999; Thornbury, 1999). It served as an aide-memoire for the post-test and allowed pupils to consult rules during independent practice.

D.5 Why these materials

The design of the materials was grounded in the following theories (Section 3.5):

Table D.3 Theoretical foundations of the teaching and learning materials

Theory	**How it shaped the materials**
Vygotsky (1978) - zone of proximal development; Wood, Bruner and Ross (1976) - scaffolding	Charts and the handout were scaffolds inside pupils' ZPD: they could convert with help before they could convert alone.
Sweller (1988) - cognitive load	The chart held the formula outside working memory so pupils could attend to the swap itself.
Bloom (1956); Anderson and Krathwohl (2001) - taxonomy / OIC levels	Materials supported movement from identifying tenses, to explaining structure, to converting.
Ebbinghaus (1885) - forgetting curve	Daily reference to the same chart countered decay of tense knowledge taught in earlier years.

D.6 Supporting materials: Computing and paragraph writing (PEEL)

Computing (Section 3.8). The following materials supported the Scratch unit, so that pupils who could not hold the whole editor in their heads could still reason about a program before touching a machine:

- Scratch interface diagram: a large labelled poster of the stage, sprite list, blocks palette and script area.
- Unplugged block cards: laminated move, turn, say and repeat cards that pupils arranged on their desks to plan a program before building it.
- Worked examples: a 'walking sprite' and a 'talking character' opened on the

projector so pupils could see a finished program and take it apart.

- Loop comparison cards: repeat (10) and forever shown side by side with a plain-language explanation of when each is used.

Paragraph writing (Section 3.11, Lesson Plan 10 resources): a colour-coded model paragraph displayed on the slide and printed on worksheets (topic: why reading matters); four highlighter colours (or four pencil patterns); a PEEL wall poster; and sentence-starter cards.

APPENDIX E

PHOTOGRAPHIC EVIDENCE OF TEACHING AND LEARNING

The photographs in this appendix are from the placement: Figures 2.1-2.7 of Section 2.4 and two photographs of the CODEAVOUR 7.0 educational visit recorded in Section 5.8. They are included as evidence of instructional practice, not as decoration. They are reproduced with the school's knowledge and are included solely for examination purposes; learner images are not for circulation beyond the examination process.

E.1 Placement photographs (Figures 2.1-2.7)



Figure 2.1: Delivering a Year 6 Computing lesson with Scratch in the school computer laboratory - evidence of instructional use of technology (see Section 4.4).



Figure 2.2: Whole-class teaching in a Year 6 classroom at St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman - evidence of the physical setting described in Section 2.1.



Figure 2.3: The main school building of St. Martin De Porres School, Dansoman - the site of the placement (see Section 2.1).



Figure 2.4: The administration block, from which the school's day-to-day operations are run.



Figure 2.5: The school's basketball court, part of the facilities available to learners outside the classroom (see Section 2.2).



Figure 2.6: With the Year 6 class and the university supervisor during a placement visit.



Figure 2.7: With the school's robotics team after placing first at CODEAVOUR 7.0, the national robotics competition the school enters annually; I was selected to join the team because I was teaching Computing at the school (see Sections 2.5 and 5.8).

E.2 CODEAVOUR 7.0 educational visit photographs (Section 5.8)



Photograph E.8: CODEAVOUR 7.0, the national schools robotics competition - photographic evidence of the educational visit during the additional school experience (see Section 5.8 and Table 5.5).



Photograph E.9: The school's robotics team at CODEAVOUR 7.0; the team placed first (see also Figure 2.7).